



# IELTS SPEAKING



Ready to face the challenge?

About to take the IELTS Speaking exam?

Learn the strategies and skills you'll need to get that top grade you're after!

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## IELTS Speaking Test Format

| Part                         | Interaction              | Task and language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>part 1</b><br>4-5 minutes | Introduction & Interview | <p>The examiner <b>greet</b>s you and then <b>introduce</b>s himself (herself) to you. The examiner <b>check</b>s your ID.</p> <p>The examiner asks you some questions about <b>topics that are familiar</b> to you.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>part 2</b><br>3 minutes   | Individual long turn     | <p>The examiner gives you a <b>card with a topic</b> written on it and some prompts to help you with your answer. You are also given a pencil and a piece of paper to make notes if you wish. You have one minute to think about the topic and prepare your answer.</p> <p>Then, you must <b>speak about the topic</b> for two minutes. The examiner may stop you if you speak longer than this. After you finish talking, the examiner may ask you one or two follow-up questions.</p> |
| <b>part 3</b><br>4-5 minutes | Two-way discussion       | <p>The examiner <b>ask</b>s you <b>some questions</b> to involve you in a discussion. The questions the examiner asks have the <b>same theme as Part 2</b>. The language required in the discussion is generally more abstract than in the other sections.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## IELTS Speaking Band Descriptor

### 1. Fluency and coherence

**Fluency** – Your examiner will look at how fluent you are – your ability to keep speaking and if you need to hesitate, self-correct and repeat yourself to keep going.

**Coherence** – Your examiner will look at how coherent you sound - how your words, ideas and thoughts flow together, using a range of words and phrases to connect and organize your ideas, help you move on to another point, etc.

### 2. Lexical resource

**Your words** – Your examiner will consider the kinds of words you use, whether they help make your ideas clear, and whether the words are understandable, appropriate and relevant to the topic. They will also see if you can choose the right word forms (e.g. bored/boring) and if you can use the right words together – collocation (e.g. environmental pollution).

**Paraphrasing, idiomatic language and less common language** – The use of idiomatic language and less common words are important at higher levels (band 7 and up). This doesn't mean that you need to use very uncommon words, or phrases and clichés that you have memorized. It takes time and practice to use idiomatic language naturally when discussing a variety of topics. The examiner also assesses your ability to paraphrase, saying what you mean using different words when you can't think of the right word or phrase.

### 3. Grammatical range and accuracy

**Sentence structure and variation** – When speaking, think about the proper use of sentences - using a mix of simple and complex structures. You need to show your examiner that you can use a range of complex structures accurately, if you want to score a higher band score.

**Number of errors** – It is also important to try and limit the number of grammatical errors you make. Become aware of the errors you usually make (e.g. articles, prepositions, subject/verb agreement) so you can make sure that your sentences are accurate.

### 4. Pronunciation and intonation

**How well you are understood** – Your examiner will be listening for how easy it is to understand you, and how clearly (and correctly) you pronounce words. They will also listen to how you use stress and intonation to emphasize important words and ideas and the use of stress to contrast ideas. They will also listen out for pronunciation errors made when you say your words.

## 10 ways to prepare for IELTS Speaking

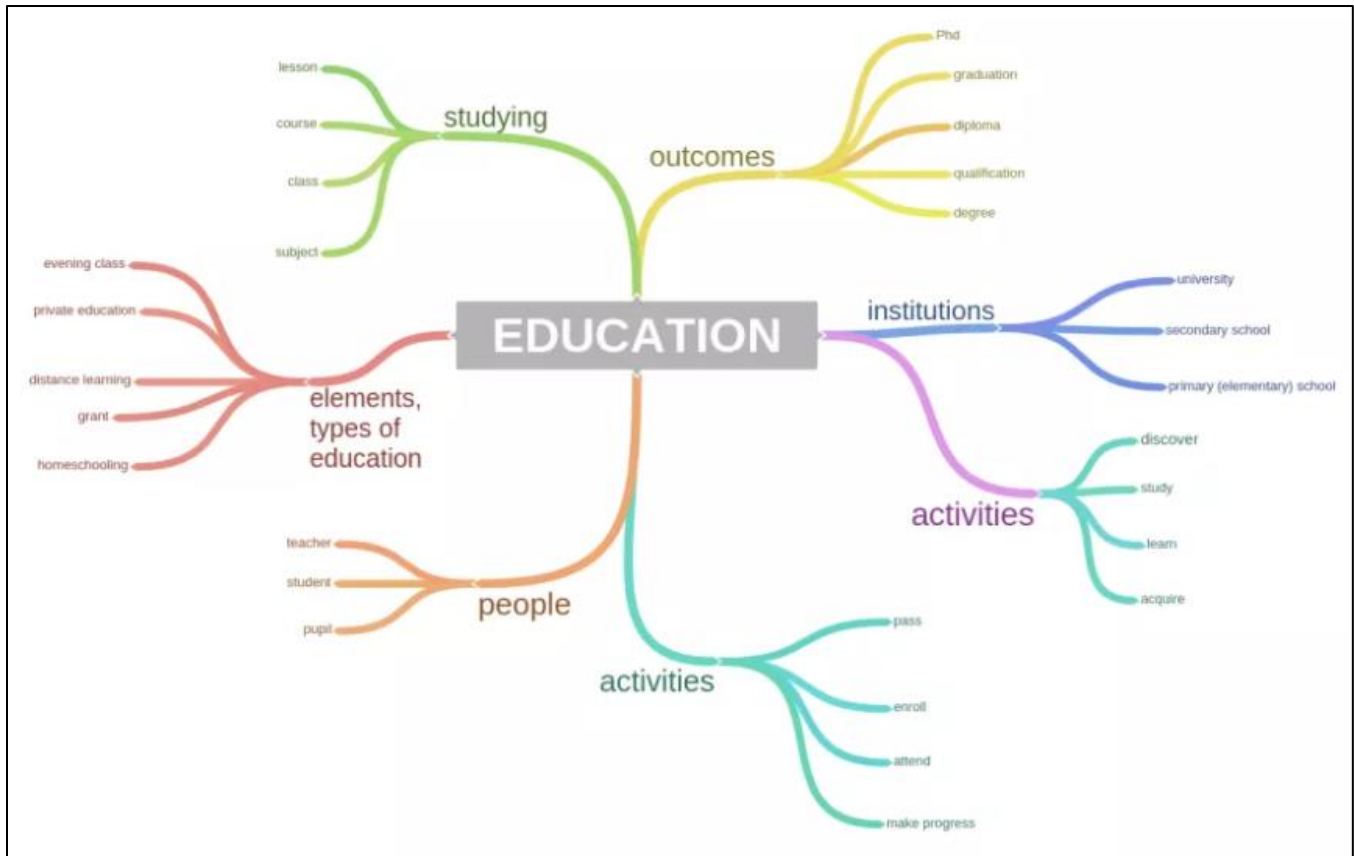
### 1. Get more IELTS Speaking practice

The more speaking practice you get on common IELTS Speaking topics like friends or your home town, the easier you'll find it to answer questions on these topics in your test.

### 2. Learn more vocabulary related to common IELTS Speaking topics

#### Mind mapping





### 3. Learn some phrases to use when you need some thinking time

You're almost certainly going to be asked some questions in your IELTS Speaking test that you'll find difficult to answer immediately. So, now's the time to learn and practice **generalization**.

### 4. Learn how to ask the examiner to repeat a question

Another way to avoid hesitating (and sound more fluent) in your Speaking test is to ask the examiner to repeat a question if you need some time to think about what to say.

- Could you repeat the question please?

### 5. Learn to use words together in phrases

You'll make fewer hesitations between words (and sound more fluent) if you learn to use natural combinations of words, i.e. collocations. Collocations are two or more words that native speakers of English often use together.

#### • adjective and nouns

Joe always wears blue or white or some other **bright color**.

We had a **brief chat** about Iraq but didn't have time to discuss it properly.

Unemployment is a **major problem** for the government these days.

Improving the health service is another **key issue** for the UK.

#### • Nouns and verbs

The **economy boomed** in 2002.

The **company has grown** and now employs over 30 people.

The **company has expanded** and now has branches in most major countries.

The four **companies merged** in 2013.

They **launched the product** in 1998.

The price increase **poses a problem** for them.

The internet has **created opportunities** for his company.

- **Noun + noun**

There are a lot of collocations with pattern **a(n) ... of ...**

a surge of anger

a sense of pride

a pang of nostalgia

- **Verb and expression with prepositions**

As Bob went on stage to receive his medal you could see his sister **swelling with pride**.

I was **filled with horror** when I read the newspaper report of the war.

When she spilt apple-juice on her new blue skirt the little girl **burst into tears**.

- **Verbs and adverbs**

He **pulled steadily** on the rope and helped her to safety.

She **placed** the beautiful jar **gently** on the window ledge.

'I love you and want to marry you,' Michael **whispered softly** to Clare.

He **smiled proudly** as he looked at the photos of his new granddaughter.

- **Adverbs and adjectives**

Ben and Jane are **happily married**.

You are **fully aware** that there are serious problems.

George was **blissfully unaware** that he was in danger.

- **Adjective + Noun + Noun**

The collocation with pattern: **a(n) (some adjective) state of repair**, is one example.

The barn was in **a poor state of repair**.

6. Only correct mistakes that you know how to correct

If you notice that you make a mistake when you're speaking but don't know how to correct your mistake, it would be better not to try and just keep on speaking.

If you stop speaking and try to correct your mistake, you may hesitate a lot as you try to find the right word or grammar.

**Five common grammar mistakes to avoid in your IELTS Speaking test:**

- Using the present tense to talk about past events  
*"I went to many shops to find it but I never find..."*
- Using the wrong word order  
*"I feel always the singer is not good in live music so..."*
- Missing out 'a' or 'the'  
*"I'm student"*
- Missing out a preposition such as 'in' or 'with'  
*"I usually listen Turkish music"*  
*"I don't agree this view"*
- Using the wrong form of a verb  
*"Everybody have..."*  
*"He work..."*

**7. Use contractions like I'm or I'd**

Use contractions like I'm or I'd in your IELTS Speaking test and you'll sound more fluent.

So...

- say I'm not I am
- say I'd not I would
- say I've not I have
- say isn't not is not
- say wouldn't not would not
- say haven't not have not

**8. Practice explaining the meaning of words**

Because you may forget a word or phrase that you need to use when answering a question in your test, it would be a good idea to practice explaining the meaning of words before your test.

You can start right now by explaining the meaning of the following words/phrases on the common IELTS topic of friends? (I've given you an example of how you could explain the first one.)

- a classmate (e.g. a boy/girl in my class)
- a close friend
- an old friend
- a small/wide circle of friends
- make new friends

- keep in contact with friends
9. Talk about ideas that you can explain easily

Getting a lot of practice answering IELTS Speaking questions before your test will help you find out what you're able to explain in English and what kind of ideas are too difficult to explain.

You'll sound more fluent in your IELTS Speaking test if you avoid ideas that you would find difficult to explain.

10. Find a way to relax before your IELTS Speaking test

Whether it's exercise, watching a movie or talking with friends (in English), do something that will help you relax before your IELTS Speaking test.

The more relaxed you are, the easier you'll find it to answer the examiner's questions.

## Using connectives and discourse markers

In order to sound convincing and confident your speech needs to be both connected and logical.

The table below lists a few of the most frequently used connectives.

| FUNCTION                          | CONNECTIVES                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| addition                          | and, also, besides, furthermore, too, moreover, then, equally important, another                                                             |
| comparison                        | like, in the same manner (way), as so, similarly                                                                                             |
| contrast                          | but, in contrast, conversely, however, still, nevertheless, yet, on the other hand, on the contrary, or, in spite of this, actually, in fact |
| order or sequence                 | first, second, (etc.), finally, next, then, to begin with, after, before, as soon as, in the end, gradually                                  |
| results                           | as a result, so, accordingly, consequently, thus, since, therefore, for this reason, because of this                                         |
| purpose                           | for this purpose, with this in mind, for this reason                                                                                         |
| to signal an example or emphasize | for example, to illustrate, for instance, to be specific, such as, especially                                                                |
| to summarize or conclude          | in summary, to sum up, to repeat, briefly, in short, finally, on the whole, therefore, as I have said, in conclusion, as you can see         |

Discourse markers are words or phrases that we use to manage what we say or write or to express attitude. They are also quite helpful in building a well-organised answer and orienting your listener as you speak.

| FUNCTION                                       | Discourse markers                                    |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| To preface what you really think               | Actually, I have to say                              |
| To confess that something is true              | I must admit                                         |
| To give yourself time to think                 | Well                                                 |
| To start, end or change topic                  | Right, so, anyway                                    |
| To say something in another way                | What I mean is, in other words                       |
| To talk about knowledge we share with listener | You know, you see                                    |
| To introduce personal opinion                  | My point is, what I'm getting at is, I mean, I guess |

### QS: Why do people want to learn a foreign language?

**Well** [to give yourself time to think], that's **because** [reason] it's very useful in modern society. **I guess** [personal opinion], language learning stopped being a hobby and turned into a trend. **That** [reference] is **due to** [reason] many real advantages in employment, relationships and health.

**First** [order], speaking more than one language can open up a great number of employment opportunities for job seekers, **especially** [emphasis] **if** [condition] that language is widely used in business. So, **if** [condition] you speak a language like English or Mandarin, you will be able to work for not only local **but** [contrast] global

businesses **too** [add ideas], with the additional advantage of a very decent salary.

**Second** [order], **if** [condition] you speak two or more languages, **this** [reference] will help you to extend your connections worldwide. **So** [result] you will be able to build lasting friendships with foreign co-workers or local people **when** [time] you travel around the world.

And **finally** [order], your brain will benefit a lot from **such a** [example] learning activity as discovering a new language. Research showed that studying another language helps prevent brain illness and keeps you more mentally fit **as well as** [add ideas] improves your memory. **In short**, [conclude] **what I'm getting at is** that [personal opinion] learning a foreign language is more than beneficial!

As you can see, this answer indeed shows a flexible use of connectives and discourse markers. They are not repeated (except several uses of **if**, which is justified) and all used appropriately.

All the ideas are organised well and the connections between them are clear and logical. Thus, using appropriate connectives will make your exam answer ordered and intelligible, and will show that you are flexible when using them and can use a certain range to express yourself in an orderly and logical manner.

**Well**, that's **because** it's very useful in modern society. **I guess**, language learning stopped being a hobby and turned into a trend. **That is due to** many real advantages in employment, relationships and health.

**First**, speaking more than one language can open up a great number of employment opportunities for job seekers, **especially if** that language is widely used in business. So, if you speak a language like English or Mandarin, you will be able to work for not only local **but** global businesses **too**, with the additional advantage of a very decent salary.

**Second**, **if** you speak two or more languages, **this** will help you to extend your connections worldwide. **So** you will be able to build lasting friendships with foreign co-workers or local people **when** you travel around the world.

And **finally**, your brain will benefit a lot from **such a** learning activity **as** discovering a new language. Research showed that studying another language helps prevent brain illness and keeps you more mentally fit **as well as** improves your memory. **In short**, **what I'm getting at is** that learning a foreign language is more than beneficial!

## Theme 1: Description

Describe/ What/ How/ Tell me

- Reaction
  - Well
  - Actually
  - Honestly
  - To be honest
- Generalise
  - I can mention many ... (Part 1/ Active)
  - Many ... could be mentioned. (Part 3/ Passive)
- Idea 1+ Support

Idea:

- The first one that comes to mind is (that) ...
- The first one coming to mind is (that) ...
- The first one that pops into my mind is (that) ...
- The first one popping into my mind is (that) ...

Support:

- This is simply because ...
- The point is that ...
- What I mean is that ...
- Especially if you consider the fact that ...
- In addition/ At the same time/ As well as this/ Also/ Furthermore
- Idea 2 + Support
  - Another ... worth mentioning is (that)

### What do you do in your free time?

Well, free time activities... I do many things in my spare time. The most enjoyable one is watching TV series. The point is that I've always been entertained by English TV series. You know, I escape into alternate realities, their worlds, I mean, I associate myself with the characters. As well as this, another leisure activity that I take pleasure in is running on the treadmill. Especially if you consider the fact that I'm fully occupied with work; I mean, I don't have time to go to the gym regularly.

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**What are the popular restaurants in your country?**

Well, actually... A wide range of restaurants could be mentioned. But I think the most important one is fast food places. This is simply because the food is inexpensive; I mean, it's made with cheaper ingredients. It's also prepared fast and easily. What I mean is that it appeals to people who are too busy to cook. At the same time, another well-liked type is traditional restaurants. The point is that they offer a wide variety of local cuisine of exquisite quality. You know, the food is simply excellent.

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**Describe your bedroom.**

Well, actually... I can say many things about my bedroom. The first thing that pops into my mind is that it's not just a place where I sleep. What I mean is that it's an ideal place to prepare for my classes since there are 3 bookshelves surrounding me along with my laptop on the study table. In addition, another great part of my bedroom is its spacious closets. The point is that it allows me to be well-organized although I have got many items of clothing.

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**What are the popular places for tourists?**

Well, honestly... so many tourist attractions could be mentioned. The first thing that comes to mind is museums. This is simply because by visiting these places you gain a complete overview of the rich heritage of this country. I mean, they are wonderful manifestations of Iranian art and culture. As well as this, another place worth mentioning is Milad Tower, which has become the symbol of Tehran. What I mean is that it is among the tallest towers in the world; actually, the main deck providing a panoramic view attracts regular visitors.

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**Theme 2: Yes/ No**

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - It depends. To some extent ... and somehow ...
  - It depends. I mean it varies from time to time/ from person to person.
- Yes + Support
- But/ However
- No + Support

**Do you cook?**

Well, to be honest I'd have to say it depends. Although I know how to cook many things, most of the times I don't. This is simply because I have a busy and hectic lifestyle, I mean, I'm fully occupied with work. So my schedule doesn't allow me to cook and I mostly order out. However, I sometimes find the time to cook. The point is that there are certain dishes that only I know how to make very well. So whenever I crave them, I prepare them to satisfy my craving.

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- Reaction
- Generalise
  - ... falls into ... categories.
  - ... is divided into ... parts.
- Category 1 + Support
- But/ However
- Category 2 + Support

**Is education free in your country?**

Well... Education in my country falls into two categories. Public and private. Public schools are maintained at public expense. What I mean is that these schools are funded and overseen by government rather than by private entities. You know, the government allocates a budget so that education is available to all. However, private schools are privately financed. The point is that they retain the right to select their students and are funded in whole by charging their students for a tuition fee. This is simply because they provide enriched learning environments, I mean the services they offer are of high quality.

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- Reaction
- Generalise
- Past (used to) + Support
- But/ However
- Now (present perfect)

**Are you on time?**

Well... to be honest, although being punctual is essential in life, it's somehow difficult to manage these days. What I mean is that I used to be on time all the time. You know, due to having less drivers, traffic congestion used to be less severe. So arriving at my destination would take a normal amount of time. However, now I sometimes arrive late to my appointments. This is simply because my city is crowded and the traffic is bumper to bumper in bustling centers. So I get stuck in heavy traffic in the rush hour, and it makes me nervous and anxious.

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### Theme 3: Present Perfect

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - ... has changed a lot/ dramatically/ radically. I mean a bunch of and loads of changes have happened.
- Past (used to) + Support
- But/ However
- Now (present perfect)

#### How has architecture changed in your country in the last 50 years?

Well, it has changed radically. I mean, a bunch of and loads of changes have happened. Architecture used to be simple. The point is that it used to be unadorned and plain, without luxurious designs. You know, most of the buildings used to be single-story homes. However, architecture has become modern. This is simply because people's tastes have changed and they are attracted to state-of-the art buildings which have posh designs. At the same time, materials have become more hi-tech. What I mean is that building materials have become more advanced and available in a wider variety of forms.

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#### How has the system of food production changed?

Well, it has changed dramatically. I mean, a bunch of and loads of changes have happened. Food production used to be more natural and organic. What I mean is that products used to be grown without the use of chemicals and hormones, thus they used to be healthier. However, food production has become more conventional. The point is that most products are exposed to pesticides in order to feed the growing population, which in turn leads to health risks such as cancer. In addition, it used to involve an enormous amount of time and effort. The point is that most of the work used to be done by human or animal labor. However, with the advent of technology, food production has modernized. You know, it has become more efficient.

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**How has your taste in music changed over the past few years?**

Well, it has changed a lot. I mean, a bunch of and loads of changes have happened. I used to listen only to English pop songs in the past. The point is that it used to be popular among my generation. I mean, it used to be appealing to me and I got enormous pleasure out of it. But my taste has changed. Nowadays, I listen to pop rock music. This is simply because it's a clever combination of pop music and rock and roll with more emphasis on professional songwriting. Listening to this genre helps me purge my thoughts and relieve stress and anxiety.

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## Theme 4: Wh- questions

When/ Where/ Who with/ How often/ How much/ How many

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - It depends. It varies from time to time.
  - It depends. It varies from person to person.
- 50%(+) (If clause I) + Support
- But/ However
- 50%(-) (If clause I) + Support

### How often do you go shopping?

Well... shopping... Actually, it depends. I mean it varies from time to time. If my schedule allows me, I'll go every weekend. The point is that for me, shopping is not only for the sake of fashion but also an effective means of relaxation... you know, it helps me relive stress and anxiety. However, you know, my life is hectic and I'm fully occupied with work. So my schedule doesn't allow me to go shopping on a regular basis.

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### Where do you go shopping?

Well... to be honest, it depends. You know, it varies from time to time. If my budget allows me, I'll go to a boutique near my house where I can spend lavishly on designer clothes. This is simply because I pay great attention to my appearance and I take pleasure in the act itself. However, because of financial problems, I'm usually on a tight budget, and I can't afford to spend money extravagantly. What I mean is that I have to be careful with money.

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**Theme 5: Would**

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - I have always thought about it. This is simply because ...
  - I have always dreamed about it. This is simply because ...
  - This isn't something that I've ever considered. This is simply because ...
- Idea 1 (If clause II) + Support
- In addition/ At the same time/ As well as this/ Also/ Furthermore
- Idea 2 + Support
  - I would also ...

**How would you improve your city?**

Well... I've always thought about it. This is simply because I've been living in Tehran since I was born. So I'm fully aware of the problems we have here. If I were given a chance to change something, I would definitely reduce traffic congestion. The point is that unfortunately, in my city, the traffic is bumper to bumper and what people usually complain about is heavy traffic jams they get stuck in. In addition, I would also improve the quality of air. Especially if you consider the fact that Tehran is among the most polluted cities in the world. It's high time someone took some action.

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**How would you improve education system?**

Well... to be honest, I've always thought about it. This is simply because I've been teaching for about ten years, and I'm fully aware of the pitfalls of our education system. If I were given a chance to do something, I would definitely focus on the individual requirements of the students. Especially if you consider the fact that there are so many students and teachers are not able to give adequate attention to each of them. In addition, I would also change the teaching style. The point is that teaching methods are not as creative and interesting as they're supposed to be. So I would develop teachers' skills.

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## Theme 6: Advantage/ Disadvantage

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - ... has some benefits/ merits/ positive points/ positive aspects/ desirable aspects
  - ... has some demerits/ drawbacks/ downsides/ negative aspects/ negative points
- Advantage/ Disadvantage 1 + Support
- In addition/ At the same time/ As well as this/ Also/ Furthermore
- Advantage/ Disadvantage 2 + Support

### What are the advantages of travelling?

Well... Travelling which has become part of almost everyone's life has some benefits. The first merit of travelling is that we learn about many different cultures. What I mean is that when we get exposed to various cultures, we learn to respect the values of other nations. This exposure also makes us tolerant and enhances our world view. As well as this, another plus point worth mentioning is that it's a great way to take a break from work and relax. The point is that these days many of us have hectic lives and travelling helps us to chill out and vent our feelings.

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### What are the disadvantages of watching TV?

Well... While television has become an inseparable part of our lives, it has some demerits. The first drawback of TV programs is that it often restrains people from doing other important activities. What I mean is that it is a total waste of valuable time. At the same time, another negative point is that watching too much television is not good for your health. The point is that it may harm our eyesight due to over-watching.

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**Theme 7: Compare**

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - When it comes to ..., there's a huge/ big difference/ distinction between ... and ...
- Idea 1 + Support + in contrast + Idea 1' + Support
  - Comparative adjectives
- In addition/ At the same time/ As well as this/ Also/ Furthermore
- Idea 2 + Support + in contrast + Idea 2' + Support
  - Comparative adjectives

**Compare men and women in shopping.**

Well... When it comes to shopping, there is a huge distinction between men and women. Women are much more interested in shopping than men. What I mean is that they take more pleasure in it. You know, it makes them happy. However, men find it a boring and tedious activity. The point is that to men, it's a waste of money and time. In addition, women are willing to spend money more lavishly and extravagantly. This is simply because they are much more fashion-conscious, so they tend to follow the latest trends no matter how much they cost. In contrast, men are much more price-conscious. What I mean is that they try to avoid buying expensive things.

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**Which one do you prefer? Living in a house or an apartment.**

Well... When it comes to places to live, there is a big difference between houses and apartments. **Personally, I would rather** live in a house. Houses are much more private. What I mean is that neighbors live in some distance and less disturbance might be caused. In contrast, due to the crowded nature of apartment buildings, the privacy offered by apartment living is much less. I mean, suffering from excessive noise from other tenants is entirely possible. In addition, houses are much more spacious. The point is that they could be easily furnished and decorated. I mean, a wider variety of choices is available. However, apartments have less space. What I mean is that they feel like cages and cannot be personalized easily.

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## Theme 8: Future

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - It would be quite hard to talk about the future of ... But it can be predicted that in the not-so-distant future, because of the growth of technology/ advancements in technology/ eco-friendly lifestyles/ environmentally-friendly processes/ population growth, it's more likely that (it's quite probable that) ... will...
- Idea 1 + Support
- In addition/ At the same time/ As well as this/ Also/ Furthermore
- Idea 2 + Support
  - We might even see that ...

### What will cars be like in the future?

Well... It would be quite hard to talk about the future of cars. But it can be predicted that in the not-so-distant future, because of the growth of technology, it's more likely that (it's quite probable that) the conventional cars will be replaced by electric ones. This is simply because cars which run on fossil fuels produce harmful pollutants which lead to respiratory and heart diseases. At the same time, we might even see that cars will fly. What I mean is that alternative roads will be built in the air to reduce the heavy traffic on Earth.

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### Do you see any future for cash money with the growth of credit cards?

Well... **I don't think so.** It would be quite hard to talk about the future of cash money. But it can be predicted that in the not-so-distant future, because of eco-friendly lifestyles, it's more likely that (it's quite probable that) it will be replaced by credit cards. The point is that eco-conscious people are trying so hard to preserve the environment. So cutting down less trees will be among their priorities. As well as this, we might even see that this replacement will take place due to safety reasons. What I mean is that it will be much more difficult to steal credit cards.

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### Theme 9: Why

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - Many reasons are behind it. I mean it could be justified by many reasons.
- Reason 1 + Support
  - The chief cause is (that) ...
- In addition/ At the same time/ As well as this/ Also/ Furthermore
- Reason 2 + Support
  - Another reason worth mentioning is (that) ...

#### **Why do people eat fast food?**

Many reasons are behind it. I mean, it can be justified by many reasons. The chief cause is that it's more convenient. The point is that most people lead a hectic life these days. I mean, they do not have the time or energy to cook proper meals. As a result, they live on fast food. In addition, another reason worth mentioning is that it suits an array of tastes and budgets. What I mean is that it is delicious and economical.

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**Cue Card**

Types:

1. Past (narrative tenses)
2. Description
3. Imaginary future (would)

- Reaction
- Generalise
  - When it comes to ..., I'd have to say .... This is simply because ...
  - But now I'm supposed to talk about .... I vividly remember that .../ If my mind serves me right ...
- Detailed notes
- Ending
  - If clause (type 1/ 2/ 3)

**Talk about an older person you admire**

**You should say:**

- **who this person is**
- **how long you have known him/her**
- **what qualities he/she has**
- **And why you admire him/her**

*When it comes to admiring people I'd have to say that I've always tried to be careful about it. This is simply because some of them often appear to be charismatic and powerful. But when you peel the onion and get to know them personally, you'll find that they're lying or faking about a whole host of things*

*But now I'm supposed to talk about a very close friend of mine, Mike, who is someone I respect greatly **(here I am adding some extra detail to who he is)**.*

*I'm not entirely sure when we met, it could have been about seven years ago... yes that's right, it was when we were both playing football for the school team... **(here I avoid saying 'I've known him for...' and make the answer longer and more detailed)***

*We're both mad about football so it was this shared love of the sport that got us talking **(here I am adding some extra detail about our friendship)**. Since leaving school, Mike has set up his own company and has become a very wealthy man.*

*He is a born leader **(now I am starting to talk about the qualities)**, you could see this when he was younger... he was the captain of the football team and head boy in our year **(and I am adding extra detail to describe this quality)**, so it's hardly surprising that he is now running his own company.*

*Another reason though is his entrepreneurial skill **(another quality)**. He set up an online company with very little money, he doesn't have a billionaire father like Donald Trump! At first, he faced lots of difficulties, but he was very determined **(another quality)** and his determination **(here I'm adding another word from the same word family to show the examiner my flexible use of language)** paid off and he now has an incredibly successful company.*

*In addition to his skills, he has great qualities such as charisma and charm **(more qualities)**. He is the most charming and charismatic **(here again I'm using words from the same word family to show the examiner my flexible use of language)** man I've ever met. '*

*Why do I admire him? **(here I am focusing back on the cue card to prepare myself to answer this question and by asking the question I am giving myself some extra thinking time)**. Well, there are a number of reasons... **(this is a useful way to remind yourself to not just say one thing)***

*Firstly **(using this helps with your band score for cohesion and coherence)**, he is a well-respected businessman and has gained the respect of all his employees. Moreover **(using this helps with your band score for cohesion and coherence)**, setting up a business in a recession is also inspirational and the fact that he never gave up despite some difficulties in the early period, makes him such a positive role model. I'm not sure if I'll be able to achieve what he has in such a short time, but he has inspired me to try so you can see why I have so much admiration for him.*

*The more time I spend with Mike, the more it I realize how much better my life could have been if I had met him sooner.*

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**A journey you have taken recently.**

- **Where**
- **When**
- **Who with**
- **Explain why it was memorable**

When it comes to travelling, I'd have to say I don't like it. This is simply because I prefer what's familiar or comfortable. I mean, I don't like change at all.

But now I'm supposed to talk about a recent journey I took. If my mind serves me right, it was about six months ago that my boyfriend and I went to north of Iran with a group of our friends. Since I get carsick, the whole ride was an unpleasant experience. You know, I was dizzy the whole time. Night had already fallen when we reached our destination. The moment I stepped out of the car, I knew it was a special place. It was absolutely breathtaking. I mean, for the first time in a long time I could see the stars. The only sound I could hear was the tree leaves rustling in the gentle breeze. It was when our friends came to greet us that I realized how much I'd missed them. We all have busy and hectic lives, so our schedules don't allow us to see each other regularly. We went in a posh villa overlooking the forest and started preparing dinner.

We stayed there for three days and all we did was having a great time. The point is that it was a great opportunity to unplug and unwind since there was no cellphone coverage. We also didn't have access to the Internet. So we spent all our time talking, laughing, playing games, singing, and dancing. We would also stay up all night and tell each other funny stories. Surprisingly, it turned out to be a great journey, and if we'd had the time, we would've definitely stayed there longer.

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## Vocabulary for IELTS Speaking Topics

### Family and friends

1. **A lifelong friend** – A friend that you have had for most of your life
2. **A relationship of trust** – a connection with another in which you have faith and confidence
3. **Arrange a dinner date** – Plan to share an evening meal
4. **A shoulder to cry on** – Someone to sympathize with you
5. **Close knit family** – A close family with common interests
6. **Dear to my heart** – Someone that I care about
7. **Distant cousins** – People who share a common ancestor but are not closely related
8. **Extend the hand of friendship** – Reach out to someone in a friendly manner
9. **Extended family** – Uncles, aunts and cousins form part of the extended family
10. **Face to face** – In person
11. **Get to know one another** – Learning different aspects of each other
12. **Get together** – Meet up
13. **Immediate family** – Spouse, parents, children, grandparents
14. **Long lost friend** – A friend that you have lost contact with
15. **Long-term relationships** – A committed relationship between partners
16. **Nurture our friendships** – Looking after our relationships with friends
17. **Professional relationships** – The relationships that we have in the workplace
18. **Relationship problems** – Difficulties with people with whom we interact regularly
19. **Share a common background** – The share a similar heritage or culture
20. **Share the same ideas** – To have similar opinions and views
21. **Stand the test of time** – To last a long time
22. **Struck up a friendship** – To make friends
23. **To enjoy someone's company** – To enjoy spending time with someone
24. **To have a good working relationship** – To work together well
25. **To have a lot in common** – To have shared interests
26. **To hit it off** – To like each other straight away
27. **To keep in touch with** – To keep in contact
28. **To lose touch with** – To lose contact

### IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you come from a large family?**

*My **immediate family** is not very big. I have a large **extended family** that includes many uncles, aunts, and cousins. We are a **close-knit family**, and we like to **keep in touch** with one another, so birthdays, and other celebrations, are noisy crowded affairs.*

**Examiner: When was the last time you had a family function?**

*Our extended family **got together** last year to celebrate my grandfather's eightieth birthday. He is **very dear to my heart**. He has kept up **healthy relationships** with the whole family, so it was a happy occasion that we all enjoyed.*

**Examiner: Would you take a friend on a family holiday?**

*I have. My family and my best friend **got to know each other quite well**, as she visited me quite frequently at my home. My family believes that we should **nurture our friendships**, so they encouraged me to bring my friend along when we took a seaside holiday last year.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Examiner: Tell me about your best friend.**

**To answer this question in full,**

- **discuss who the person is,**
- **the circumstances of your meeting,**
- **and what it is that you like about them.**

*My best friend and I got to know each other when we were still very young. We lived in neighbouring houses. We had **a lot in common**, so we soon **hit it off**.*

*As we have grown older, we have moved apart. Because of this, we have to some degree **lost touch**, but anyone who has had a **lifelong friend** would understand that she will always be dear to my heart.*

*When we do find ourselves in the same city, we **arrange a dinner date**, so that we can **enjoy each other's company**. We **share the same ideas**, and **we share a common background**.*

*We enjoy reminiscing about our past exploits. When we **struck up a friendship**, as children, we were inseparable. In those early days, we built up **a relationship of trust** that time and distance cannot break.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Do you think that after-hour friendships between working colleagues are appropriate?**

*I think that it is important to have **a good working relationship**. Colleagues should **extend the hand of friendship** to newcomers in the workplace. I don't believe, however, that **professional relationships** should extend into the domestic domain as this may affect office politics.*

**Examiner: Do you think that social media is changing the way that we relate to our friends and family?**

*In some ways yes. Social media allows us to **build up relationships** with **distant cousins**, even with those that live on foreign soil. It also helps us to make connections with **long lost friends**, who we may never have spoken to or seen again. On the other hand, we often spend far too much time on our digital devices instead of socializing **face to face**.*

**Examiner: Do you think that people who enter into a long-term relationship, should continue with their friendships from their single days?**

*I think that it is important to **nurture our friendships** whether or not we are in a **long-term relationship**. Not all relationships **stand the test of time**, and if you have **relationship problems** you may one day need **a shoulder to cry on**. In my view, too many people abandon their friends when they become involved in relationships.*

Food vocabulary

1. **A balanced diet** – A diet that has the right amount of nutrients
2. **A bottle of bubbly** – Sparkling wine
3. **A decadent chocolate pudding** – Luxurious or self-indulgent chocolate pudding
4. **A doggy bag** – The leftovers of a meal in a restaurant taken home
5. **A scrumptious meal** – A delicious meal
6. **A sweet tooth** – An enjoyment of sweet food
7. **An English breakfast** – A large cooked breakfast that includes egg and bacon
8. **Calm the hunger pangs** – To reduce the discomfort caused by hunger
9. **Candle lit dinner** – A romantic dinner by candlelight
10. **Covered in a rich sauce** – Covered in a creamy gravy
11. **Cut down on** – To reduce consumption
12. **Daily consumption** – The amount that you eat everyday
13. **Dying of hunger** – Very hungry
14. **Exotic meals** – Meals that originate in other countries
15. **Fine dining** – Food catering to expensive tastes in a formal setting
16. **Food preparation** – Preparing food
17. **Food production** – Producing food
18. **Fussy eater** – Someone dislikes many foods
19. **Home cooked meals** – Meals cooked at home
20. **Homemade food** – Food made at home
21. **Junk food** – Food with little nutritional value
22. **Leafy vegetables** – Vegetables such as spinach and cabbage
23. **Mouth-watering meals** – Delicious meals
24. **Nutritious food** – Food with many nutrients
25. **Packed with vitamins** – Full of vitamins
26. **Piping hot cup of coffee** – Very hot coffee
27. **Pub lunch** – Lunch served in a bar
28. **Rabbit food** – Salad vegetables
29. **Ready meals** – Heat and eat meals
30. **Refined carbohydrates** – Foods such as white rice, white bread
31. **Savoring the food** – Enjoying the food
32. **Scrumptious meal** – An exceptionally tasty meal
33. **Seasonal fruits** – Fruits that grow in season
34. **Starving hungry** – Extremely hungry
35. **Wining and dining** – Entertainment that includes good food

**IELTS speaking part 1**

**Examiner: What food do you like to eat?**

*I am not **a fussy eater**. As long as you don't feed me **rabbit food** I'm easy to please. My flatmate and I share the cooking chores. Once a week we make a **slap-up meal** of steak and chips **covered in a rich sauce** and to satisfy **the sweet tooth** we finish off with **a decadent chocolate pudding**.*

**Examiner: So, do you enjoy cooking?**

*I prefer eating to cooking. I make good use of **ready meals** and I am not averse to **junk food** or the occasional **pub lunch**. I realize though that it is necessary to include **nutritious food** in my diet, which is why I cook several times a week.*

**Examiner: What's your favourite meal of the day?**

*I'm a breakfast fan. I wake up **starving hungry** after a good night's sleep. I like nothing better than a good **English breakfast** of bacon, eggs, and buttery toast, along with a **piping hot cup of coffee**.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Examiner: Tell me about your favourite restaurant**

**In this question, you should discuss**

- **the restaurant that you like best,**
- **why you like it,**
- **and the occasions when you go there.**

*I enjoy **fine dining** and **exotic food**. Both are available at my favourite restaurant in the centre of town. On special occasions I take my partner **wining and dining**. We love the ambience of the **candle-lit dinners**, and the extensive menu of **mouth-watering meals**.*

*The menu includes starters, mains and deserts. Usually by the time we get there I am **dying of hunger** so we order a starter to **calm the hunger pangs**. We usually also share a **bottle of bubbly**. It is after all a celebration. Having finished our starter we take our time, **savouring the food**.*

*This is not the type of restaurant where you would ask for a **doggy bag**, so we waste nothing. We end the evening with a delicious dessert. After settling the bill, we head off home, satisfied that we have **enjoyed a scrumptious meal**.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Do you believe that the 21st Century diet is a healthy one?**

*Far too many people are overweight. I believe that people should **cut down on** sugars and **refined carbohydrates** and replace them with **leafy vegetables** and **seasonal fruits**. A **balanced diet** would help them to regulate their weight.*

**Examiner: Starvation is a problem in many parts of the world. What do you think should be done about it?**

*From what I've read current global **food production** can cover the **daily consumption** needs of the world. We need to find a way to economically transport it to where it is most needed or find alternate **food sources**. Nobody should starve when there is no **shortage of food**.*

**Examiner: In homes where both parents work do you think cooking has become just another job at the end of the day?**

*I know that **food preparation** can be time-consuming, but if everyone helps with ideas and recipes and everyone takes a turn and lends a hand, cooking can be fun for the family. **Home cooked meals** are also often healthier and **packed with vitamins**.*

## Travel

1. **Affordable destinations** – Places within a reasonable price range
2. **Affordable travel** – Travel which is within your price range
3. **Around the world** – In all corners of the globe
4. **Arts and culture** – The art, music and other cultural aspects of an area
5. **Craft markets** – Stalls where goods made by the local people are sold
6. **Do as the locals do** – Enjoy the activities as the local people do
7. **Efficient public transport** – A functioning transport system intended for the use of residents and visitors
8. **Exotic destinations** – Unusual or strange holiday destinations
9. **Get around** – Get from place to place
10. **Guided tours** – Walking, hiking or driving visits led by a guide who knows the area
11. **Holiday brochures** – Pamphlets advertising holiday destinations
12. **Holiday destination** – Place to which you leave on holiday
13. **Long haul flights** – Long distance flights
14. **Lush rainforests** – Luxuriant equatorial forests
15. **Magnificent landscapes** – Impressive scenery
16. **Make advance reservations** – Booking ahead of time
17. **Memorable experiences** – Activities that you will remember for years
18. **Off the beaten track** – A place that is not on the main thoroughfare
19. **Out of season** – Outside the most popular holiday period
20. **Packaged deals** – Travel deals that are put together by an agency and sold as a package
21. **Quaint villages** – Old fashioned or charming small towns
22. **Scenic views** – Lovely scenes
23. **Self-catering accommodation** – A Place to stay where you see to your own food
24. **Spectacular beaches** – Impressive sandy shorelines
25. **Stunning architecture** – Magnificent buildings
26. **Swarming with tourists** – Full of holidaymakers
27. **Time on their hands** – Available time to do as you choose
28. **To get away from it all** – To get away from everyday routines
29. **To go sightseeing** – Take a trip around an area to see what it has to offer
30. **Travel abroad** – Travel to overseas destinations
31. **Travelling light** – Travelling with little luggage
32. **Value for money** – A good return on investment
33. **Visa regulations** – Laws that relate to entry into a country
34. **Wildlife safari** – A guided tour through a game park

## IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Where do you like to travel during the holidays?**

*I like to **travel abroad** but it can be expensive, so I usually plan **affordable travel**. Travelling to **holiday destinations** when it is **out of season** saves a lot of money. **Out of season travel** is also the best way to avoid places that are **swarming with tourists**.*

**Examiner: What are your favourite holiday pastimes?**

*I like to **get away from it all**. I look for **exotic destinations** with **scenic views** that are **off the beaten track**. I tend to avoid **guided tours** and **packaged deals** as I prefer to **go sightseeing** on my own.*

**Examiner: How do you plan and prepare for your holiday?**

*I always do my research. I thumb through **holiday brochures** and check travel sites like Airbnb on the Internet. I'm drawn to **spectacular beaches** and **lush forests**. I usually make **advance reservations** for **self-catering accommodation**.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Examiner: Describe one of your best travel experiences.**

This type of question supports a when, where and who reply.

*Last year a friend and I took a **long-haul flight** to Peru. We were **travelling light** so we were able to really **get around**. We stayed in **quaint villages** and hiked through **lush rainforests**. We were determined to **do as the locals do**, so we stayed with local people for part of the trip. We visited colourful **craft markets** and brought back souvenirs, to remind us of our trip. One of my most **memorable experiences** was to the Sacred Valley of the Incas. It is a little bit **off the beaten track** but it is surrounded by great **scenic beauty** and **magnificent landscapes**.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: What type of holiday destination do you think attracts most tourists?**

*I know that many people are drawn to **wildlife safaris**. This is certainly one of the big attractions in Africa. In Europe and Asia, the **stunning architecture**, museums and **arts and culture** attract thousands of tourists every year.*

**Examiner: Do you think that the tourism industry will continue to grow in the next two decades?**

*I do. Many European and Asian countries have aging populations who will have **time on their hands** in the future. Many of them are likely to seek **holiday destinations around the world**. Today there are many **affordable destinations** that offer **good value for money**.*

**Examiner: What do you think that your country could do to attract more tourists?**

*My country has stringent **visa regulations**. If these were relaxed, I think that more visitors would choose to visit. We have an **efficient public transport**, plenty of accommodation and natural and historical places of interest.*

## Modern technology

1. **Access to the Internet** – Able to connect to the Internet
2. **Advances in technology** – Progressive forward movement in technology
3. **Back up your files** – To save your data to another device
4. **Become rapidly obsolete** – Quickly become out of date
5. **Computer literate** – Adequate knowledge of a computer
6. **Control remotely** – To control technology from a distance
7. **Downloading from the Internet** – Take data off one computer to another via the Internet
8. **Electronic Funds Transfer** – EFT Payment via the Internet
9. **Emerging technology** – Brand new machines and software
10. **Glued to the screen** – Unable or unwilling to leave the digital device
11. **Hacking into the network** – To gain illegal access to the computer
12. **Internet access** – The ability to enter the Internet
13. **Internet of Things** – A network connecting machines in a location so that they can be remotely controlled
14. **Internet-enabled** – Machines or appliances that have Internet access
15. **Keep a hard copy** – Keep a paper copy
16. **Labour saving device** – An appliance that saves work
17. **Not rocket science** – It is not very difficult
18. **Online piracy** – The downloading of licenced media without payment
19. **Re-install the programs** – To put computer programs back onto the computer
20. **Shop online** – Shop via the Internet
21. **Shut down** – Turn the computer off
22. **Social media networks** – Online platforms for communication between people and organisations
23. **State of the art technology** – The best technology available
24. **Surfing the web** – To move from one site to another on the Internet
25. **To click on an icon** – To use the mouse to click on the pictures to get into programs
26. **To crash** – To stop working suddenly
27. **To Log in** – To sign onto the computer
28. **To upgrade your computer system** – To get a larger, quicker or more modern computer
29. **Wireless hotspots** – A location where the Internet is available

## IELTS speaking part 1

### What type of technology do you use in your home?

We have a number of **labour-saving devices** including **state of the art technology** in our kitchen. These appliances include an induction stove, a dishwasher, and an **Internet-enabled** refrigerator. All are connected through the **Internet of Things** so we can **remotely control** them.

### Are you comfortable using modern technology?

You don't have to be a **rocket scientist** to use technology today. It's all about **booting up**, **logging in** and then **clicking on the icon** that will take you to your favourite application. On the single occasion that my **computer crashed**, I called someone in to **re-install the programs** otherwise I'm comfortable.

### How do you keep your computer and data secure?

*I always **shut down the computer** at night. I **backup my files** to a hard drive and I always **keep hard copies** of important documents. I am very careful with my privacy settings, especially in **wireless hotspots**.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

### Describe an item of modern technology that is most important to you?

In this type of question, you should describe the type of technology that you use, how long you have been using it, how frequently you use it and how it is a necessary part of your life.

*My laptop is the most important digital appliance in my home. I have had a laptop for years, but I have recently **upgraded my computer**.*

*I am **computer literate**. I study from home and I need **Internet access** to do my research. **Advances in technology** have also made it possible for me to work from home. I **surf the web** in search of freelance opportunities.*

*In my leisure time, I **download books and music from the Internet**. I pay for these via **Electronic Funds Transfer**. I do not condone online piracy, as I value the arts and believe that the authors and songwriters should be rewarded for their work.*

*I use **social media networks** to keep up with my friends and family across the globe and I also **shop online** from time to time.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

### Do you think that there are any disadvantages to modern technology?

*I think that there are several disadvantages. Security can be a problem with people **hacking into the Internet**. Also, modern technology tends to **become rapidly obsolete** so we become more and more a throw-away society. People are also losing physical contact with one another as they become **glued to their screens**.*

### In what ways do you think people will benefit from technologies in the future?

***Emerging technology** has the capacity to change our lives in so many ways. Robots and **artificial intelligence** are both reducing the amount of tedious work required in a wide range of industries and professions. We can now also get expert advice from across the globe using an **internet connection**.*

### In your opinion what are the basic computer skills that every person should have today?

*All the information we require is available on the Internet, so everyone should be able to **boot up a computer**, **log in** and know how to **use a search engine**. Everyone should have **access to the Internet** so that they can **surf the web**.*

Coronavirus

1. **Coronavirus**
2. **Covid 19**
3. **SARS**
4. **Outbreak**
5. **Epidemic**
6. **Pandemic**
7. **Droplets**
8. **Masks**
9. **Social distancing**
10. **Quarantine**
11. **Lock down**
12. **Shelter in place**
13. **Asymptomatic**
14. **Community spread**
15. **Contact tracing**
16. **Flatten the curve**
17. **ICU**
18. **Ventilators**
19. **Vulnerable**
20. **Immune- compromised**
21. **High risk**
22. **Vaccine**
23. **Pre-clinical stage**
24. **Phase 1**
25. **Phase 2**
26. **Phase 3**

## The environment and pollution

1. **outskirts of large towns:** areas outside the city centre, suburbs or industrial district
2. **factory emissions:** smoke and pollution from factories
3. **toxic fumes:** smoke which is poisonous
4. **traffic jams:** large queues of cars not moving
5. **pollutants in foods:** dangerous chemicals
6. **pesticides:** chemicals to keep bugs and animals away from plants
7. **chemical fertilizers:** chemicals added to make soil stronger
8. **commute to work:** drive or travel to work every day
9. **Mantra:** frequently repeated statement
10. **reuse and recycle:** use products again or find another purpose for them
11. **industrial waste is incinerated:** waste which is burnt
12. **facilities for recycling:** places where you can dispose of plastic / cardboard
13. **education programme:** teaching and learning in school or elsewhere
14. **consequences:** the outcomes
15. **interspersed with (birds):** mingled with, mixed with
16. **campaign:** high profile policy for the public
17. **scientists predict:** ideas for the future
18. **disintegrate:** break down into small particles
19. **microplastics:** very tiny pieces
20. **single-use applications:** use once then throw out
21. **own- brand products:** unique to the shop or supermarket
22. **policy should be rolled out:** implemented all over the country
23. **documentaries:** factual TV programmes

### IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Has there been an increase in pollution where you live?**

*Yes, there has been a dramatic increase in recent years as many of the most productive factories are built on the **outskirts of large towns** and some are even in quite central areas so very near where people live. Air pollution, as a result of **factory emissions** and **toxic fumes** has become a real problem.*

**Examiner: How has this pollution had an impact on daily life, do you think?**

*I think there are two key areas which have been most affected – firstly, our health, as air pollution is terrible in the city centre because too many **workers commute** and rely heavily on their cars rather than travelling by public transport and there are many **traffic jams**. Secondly, on the quality of crops and in rural areas, where the use of **pesticides** and **chemical fertilizers** in farming has contributed to a dangerous amount of **pollutants in foods**.*

**Examiner: Are residents in your town good at recycling?**

*Sadly, in my opinion, not nearly good enough. I know in many European countries, the **mantra of reuse and recycle** plastics and cardboards has become automatic but here there is still a culture of throwing everything away and most domestic as well as **industrial waste is incinerated**. Obviously, this policy just contributes to worsening air pollution and to plastic being thrown into the sea.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

Describe a time when you have caused pollution,

You should say:

- When this was
- What it was
- Where it was

And the impact which you think this might have caused.

*I would like to describe a moment when I was on holiday a few years ago in a really beautiful part of India on holiday with a group of friends. We had been travelling around India for a month and I think I had adjusted to seeing a huge amount of waste on the streets. Not surprisingly, there were very limited **facilities for recycling** – this is not really part of the culture and it would require a huge investment to put in place the equipment and education programme needed.*

*We were travelling on a train and had been sleeping as it was a very long journey and early the next morning when we pulled into the station, everyone leaned out of the window and purchased bottles of water, cups of tea and hot food from excited street sellers on the platforms.*

*I was happy to join in with the locals and without even thinking drank my water then threw the bottle back out of the window which is something I would never have done back home. It wasn't until later that I understood the consequences of this action.*

*After winding through the countryside for hours, the train finally reached the coast. I was stunned – rather than a beautiful, clear blue stretch of ocean, all I could see was **plastic waste** – bottles, bags, food packaging as well as larger items of industrial items were just floating, interspersed with a few seabirds who looked utterly confused and were not really able to swim.*

*I could clearly see the impact of my careless action on the train and the problem of plastics in the ocean became horribly evident. With no other way of disposing of rubbish, the temptation, indeed, the default had become to simply throw bottles and bags on the ground or into the sea, river or lake and so much of this has ended up in the ocean. Since then I have been rigorous about waste and campaigned to make sure my local town has widely available recycling bins for all.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

Examiner: What should be done about plastic in the ocean?

*While quite a lot has been done already to highlight this terrible problem, I think more could be done to make sure the public know the dangers. Apparently around **350 million tonnes** of plastic are being produced each year and around 8 million tonnes of plastic enter the ocean every year.*

*If waste management practices don't improve, **scientists predict** this amount could increase tenfold by 2025. What happens is that while paper will eventually **disintegrate**, plastic does not do this and so when it does eventually break up, it still leaves smaller fragments called **microplastics**, which have been identified in commercial fish consumed by humans.*

**Examiner: What might some solutions be to reduce this situation?**

*I think many manufactures should work really hard to reduce the use of what is called **single-use applications**, plastics which are used just once and then disposed of as this makes up approximately half of all plastics. Plastic can quite easily be recycled and used again for shampoo bottles for example. Some large companies have already started only using recycled plastics for their **own- brand products** and this kind of **policy should be rolled out** as widely as possible.*

**Examiner: What would you say to children who are faced with this problem for the future?**

*I would try to encourage teachers and parents to explain the situation to youngsters but also to try and be positive about what can be done. Firstly, we all need to be much more careful about recycling which is not impossible and should start at school as well as in the home.*

*There have been many incredible **documentaries** informing us all about the **global plastic problem** and awareness is a very important stage in beginning to stop the problem. I am not sure what is being done at the moment to remove this **mass of plastic** but we must make sure we do not make this worse, and we **protect our planet** as well as the **wildlife and birds** and we should protect the next generation who will also have to try to find solutions.*

People, personalities and characters

1. **confident**: in control
2. **awkward**: uncomfortable
3. **underneath the surface, I am paddling like a swan**: looking calm but not feeling it.
4. **put up a façade**: to pretend to be something you are not
5. **a control freak**: to want to do things yourself
6. **an eye for detail**: making sure everything is perfect
7. **reliable** and **dependable**: be trusted not to let someone down
8. **punctuality**: being on time
9. **disrespectful**: impolite
10. **a negative trait**: bad characteristic
11. **parental way**: behave like a mother or father
12. **interpersonal skills**: be good at talking to others
13. **empathetic**: understanding others emotions
14. **generous listener**: take time to hear what others are saying
15. **to emulate**: to be like
16. **considerate**: kind and thoughtful
17. **insecure**: shy and not confident
18. **moody**: sometimes happy and sometimes sad/ cross

IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you enjoy meeting new people?**

*Yes, I do, but I admit that it does depend on the context. For example, if I am with a group of life long friends as well, I feel more **confident** and relaxed than if I am alone, when I feel more timid and awkward.*

*I think that at work I try to put up a **façade of being professional** and in control although underneath the surface I **am paddling like a swan**.*

**Examiner: Would you describe yourself as a sociable person?**

*I'd like to say so, as I am always happy to get involved in organising parties and gatherings – indeed I can be a bit of a **control freak**, as I have **an eye for detail**. However, I would be more than delighted to be described as **reliable** and **dependable** as we all need **friends we can rely on**.*

*I have known my best friends since school, and we trust each other completely and **pick up where we left off** each time we see each other.*

**Examiner: Are you usually punctual or late?**

*That's a great question! Every year I make a resolution to be on time for both work and social meetings, but I have a terrible habit of always being slightly late.*

*I know that **punctuality** is a virtue and I am always embarrassed by being a **bad time keeper**, especially when I understand that being late is rude and **disrespectful**. I will keep working on improving this **negative trait**.*

IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a person you would like to be similar to. You should say**

- **Who this person is?**
- **What this person does?**
- **What qualities this person has and explain why you would like to be similar to this person?**

*I'd like to talk about a teacher who is Head of Pastoral care at a school I used to go to. Pastoral duties revolve around the mental and social health of students more than the academic side but of course, the two work in tandem.*

*This lady, Mrs Butler, has held this job for more than a decade, and she is **inspiring** in her **attention to detail** and caring personality.*

*It is her job to interact with students, in a relaxed, almost **parental way** and create the kind of atmosphere where they can trust her, and share any problems and issues they may have.*

*As part of her duties, she would liaise between the students and other members of staff, education, and healthcare professional bodies, and parents as needed.*

*The **interpersonal and communication skills** required for this role are very demanding and take a long time to learn if not acquired naturally.*

*Mrs. Butler is enormously empathetic, she really understands emotion and is a great and generous listener and I believe these are all key qualities that are important **to emulate**.*

*I think that interacting with students and colleagues at work can present many challenges and an understanding of human characteristics, even the psychology, of how people think and respond to each other is more and more important.*

*I would love to be considered as caring, considerate, and reliable as she is and she is really one of those rare people who can connect with anyone, anywhere.*

**IELTS speaking part 3**

**Examiner: How do you think the personalities of men and women vary?**

*It is often said that men can be more **opinionated** and less empathetic than women and it is true that this is often a **male stereotype**.*

*However, compared to previous generations, many men today are more in touch with their feelings, less **moody** and are much more aware of the challenges faced by regarding juggling a family and parenthood.*

**Examiner: How do companies try to assess the personalities of people who are applying for jobs?**

*Rather than a traditional interview nowadays, many companies demand high grades in psychometric tests which have been designed to test character in order to select candidates who are compatible with the company mentality.*

*Whilst these tests may highlight **insecure** or weaker candidates, I am not convinced that it is the most effective way to judge personality.*

**Examiner: Why do you think they do this?**

*In my opinion, these tests are used to save time as most jobs today attract numerous applicants and it must be hard to choose the strongest and most suitable.*

*That said, to be defined by an algorithm or computer program is terrifying and critics suggest that it cannot effectively determine those with good communication skills or **natural leaders**.*

## Fitness and health

1. **balanced diet:** eating a sensible mix of different foods
2. **conscientious about my health:** watching and caring about your health
3. **flavorsome and appealing:** good to eat and looking attractive
4. **convenient take away:** food which you can eat at home
5. **healthier eating habits:** eating less sugar or salt
6. **productive at work:** achieving more, better results
7. **processed meat:** meat in which there are additives or chemicals
8. **function successfully:** to work, perform in a great way
9. **tempted by diets:** interested in other ways of eating
10. **adopted a vegan diet:** a vegan does not eat meat, or dairy foods
11. **broad minded:** open to other ideas
12. **Skeptical:** not believing something
13. **over production of meat:** factories or agricultural methods which are focused on this
14. **Public service education message:** advice from the government
15. **Positive reinforcement:** rewarding people for doing the right thing

### IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: In what ways do you try to stay healthy?**

*I try to have a **balanced diet** as often as I can which means including plenty of fresh fruit and vegetables and I also try exercise regularly – either running or going for a bike ride, but I admit that with all my studies at the moment, I am not always as **conscientious about my health** as I should be.*

**Examiner: Do you and your friends eat much junk food?**

*I'd like to say no, as I am aware of how important it is to be healthy, and obviously junk foods contain large amounts of salt and sugar to make it **flavorsome and appealing** to taste. However, as a student, I am often tempted by a quick and **convenient take away**, and in recent times, it's been really useful to have ready meals delivered without having to leave home!*

**Examiner: What part of your lifestyle would you most like to make healthier?**

*That's a hard question! Every year I make a resolution to do more exercise, to adopt **healthier eating habits** and to go to bed earlier in order to be more effective and **productive at work** and when I study but this is much **easier said than done**.*

*I have recently taken up ballroom dancing with some colleagues from work, and this has given us the opportunity to keep fit, learn **new skillful dance techniques**, and have lots of fun simultaneously! I'd love to be as good as the dancers on Strictly Come Dancing which is a very popular TV show.*

### IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a change you have made to benefit your own healthy lifestyle**

**You should say:**

- **What it is**
- **Why you decided to do it**
- **How you have benefitted from it**
- **and explain why you would recommend it to others**

*I have always been interested in Health, Diet and Nutrition as I am aware that this is extremely important to **function successfully, sleep well and to prevent illness**. I have been **tempted by diets** over the years, but my determination usually fluctuates quite a lot and they can be pretty boring, as well as rigorous. However, recently one of my flatmates **adopted a vegan diet** and, because we share a kitchen, I decided to be as **broad minded** as possible and learn from her!*

*There's been a lot of stuff in the media about how **unhealthy** it is to eat too much meat, especially red meat and **processed meat**. I was already fairly healthy and ate a balanced diet, but when I started to read about veganism and the potential benefits of eating meat, I was hooked and determined to make some changes myself.*

*In fact, I recently watched a documentary on Netflix about a professional sportsman who was even more successful after becoming vegan, and this was revealing and surprising, **as I had imagined that he would have needed vast quantities of meat** to be strong. (note – grammar third conditional which is quite unusual!)*

*At first, the cooking was both time consuming and challenging, involving a vast range of new ingredients, techniques and recipe books, but it was fun at the same time, and our kitchen soon became a hub of not just friends but delicious odours!*

*After a few months, I decided to make this change and, whilst I do occasionally miss not enjoying a large steak, I feel healthier, have lost weight, feel energised and much more alert at work. I know too that have cut down my risk of serious disease such as a stroke or heart attack and this is reassuring.*

*I would definitely recommend cutting down on red meat and processed food to all my friends, even those who are rather **skeptical** about vegans and argue that this diet is too complicated and limited. We all know that the **over production of meat** is damaging to the environment and as an added bonus, being partly vegan has definitely saved me money as the price of meat has risen steadily in price over the past few years.*

### IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Do you think more could be done to encourage health in your country?**

*I think, in my country that the policy makers should have more **initiatives** and implement stricter policies when it comes to activities that affect people's health. For example, the banning of smoking in public places would not just benefit the smokers, but the non-smokers as well as there is much evidence about the dangers of passive smoking and **air pollution**. Also, there is a **well-established link between** better education and health care so education in school is important.*

**Examiner: How can individuals take more responsibility for their own health?**

*For me, this links back to education which should really start at school and then continue throughout one's life. The more we look after ourselves and make the **correct decisions** surrounding food, health, exercise and so on, the less we might need from our overstretched **health services** and hospitals.*

*For example, campaigns to eat less sugar, cut down on fizzy drinks and sugary snacks, and eat more fruit have been very successful recently and by educating the young, they, in turn, will influence their own families increase their vegetable and **fruit intake**.*

**Examiner: What could be done to halt the rise of obesity globally?**

*In my opinion the government has a huge responsibility to try to persuade people to live more healthily and the rise of obesity or **overweight children** as well as adults is very worrying. It is very distressing to see young children in pushchairs being given cans of fizzy drinks and sweets as a reward to good behaviour.*

*As well as education in school, governments could educate adults through a series of TV programmes, magazine adverts or **public service education messages** to raise awareness of the **risk and dangers of obesity** and a poor diet. A **positive reinforcement** message would be more effective than more negative messaging. For example, **free gym membership**, recipe cards and access to more playing fields, parks and green spaces which would contribute to making exercise not only accessible but fun too!*

## School and Education

1. **authentic:** real, true
2. **old-school strict:** traditional learning with punishments and controlling teachers
3. **teacher centred:** where the teacher is leading the class
4. **encourage collaboration:** learning together through discussions
5. **pressure to meet deadlines:** having to finish work by a certain time / date
6. **assignments:** homework or essays
7. **sail through them:** not to have to work hard and to find things easy
8. **learning expectations:** what the teacher expects from their student
9. **role plays:** acting out a situation to simulate or practice it
10. **dictation:** writing down what the teacher says, accurately and fast.
11. **breakthrough:** a new development
12. **inspiring:** something which makes you want to do better
13. **intonation:** the 'singing' sound of speech
14. **paid off:** was worth the effort
15. **outdated:** old fashioned
16. **league tables:** tables which rank the position of schools according to academic success
17. **alumni:** students who used to go to a certain school or college
18. **boarding school:** where students live at school during the term time
19. **extra- curricular activities:** anything NOT academic, eg sport, drama
20. **peer group:** students of your own age, in your class
21. **remote:** not being physically there / learning via computer

### IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: What did you enjoy most when you were at school?**

*School feels like a long time ago now, as I am currently at University, but I do remember really enjoying English lessons. We were lucky enough to have a native speaking teacher, which was usual, but it gave us the opportunity to be inspired by hearing **authentic** pronunciation and our teacher told very funny stories to keep us focused.*

**Examiner: Do you think a teacher should be friendly or strict?**

*When I was at school, our teachers were 'old-school', strict and very traditional, so our lessons were teacher centred. As children we were not encouraged to ask questions or voice our opinions. However, today, thankfully, classes are more student centred, and encourage collaboration and I think a more friendly teacher would be more successful here.*

**Examiner: What's the most difficult part of your study now?**

*Well, for the most part, I'd say it's **encourage collaboration**. I mean there are so many **assignments**, and students are always under a lot of **pressure to meet deadlines**. I am lucky as I don't find exams too overwhelming. If you are well prepared, they are entirely **predictable**, and I can pretty much **sail through them** with only a bit of revision.*

### IELTS speaking part 2

## Describe a subject you enjoyed studying at school.

### You should say:

- **when and where you started studying it**
- **what lessons were like**
- **what made it different from other subjects**

### and explain why you enjoyed the subject.

*To be honest, I found school pretty challenging for a number of reasons. We moved house quite often back then, so I had to adapt to different teachers, **learning expectations** and to make new friends. However, the subject which I was always passionate about and determined to succeed in was French.*

*I started lessons when I was quite young, which is common in the UK, as learning languages is actively encouraged, but the **standard** and expectation was relatively low so lessons revolved around **role plays** asking for ice cream or bread! Our lessons involved a lot of writing and **dictation** which was hard, and I did struggle to see the point of this as what I really wanted to learn was how to communicate and be understood. Our vocabulary was based around the family, food, travel and school so it was quite useful but not the sort of things that children really want to talk about.*

*I was motivated as I had already visited France on holiday and so I could see for myself the possible benefits of being able to communicate and make myself understood. The **breakthrough** for me came when I was around 15 with a teacher called Mrs. Green. She was half French herself, so she spoke beautifully and was rather glamorous too and her lessons were filled with laughter, games and stories although she was very strict as well. We were all expected to study hard and to succeed in exams. She was **inspiring** though because she loved her subject.*

*Personally, I have always enjoyed listening to languages, to the **intonation** and sound even if I do not understand. Once I could use the French I had learnt in school when I visited France and later studied there, the language came alive and all that hard work as a youngster **paid off**!*

## IELTS speaking part 3

### Examiner: Do you think single sex schools are still relevant in today's world?

*While today many would argue that traditional schools which only allow either girls or boys to study there seem rather **outdated** and old fashioned as this is not how 'real' society of the workplace operates. However, many **league tables** which rank schools in order of high exam results, have proved that single sex schools can be much better as there are less **distractions** and maybe students are more able to focus on learning and be proud of their achievements without having to compete with the opposite sex.*

### Examiner: What are the benefits of a boarding school?

*As an **alumni** of a **boarding school**, I can see the upsides as well as the challenges. In some countries children as young as 8 are sent away to school, either because of the higher standard of education on offer, or because their parents may be working overseas. Many of these schools offer a wide range of **extra-curricular activities** such as golf, photography or fashion as well as the core academic subjects. Children usually speak of forming*

*lifelong friendships, with their **peer group** as well as teachers and there is a strong concept of shared experiences.*

**Examiner: What are the advantages of studying a distance learning course?**

*For many people, especially students who work or need more flexibility, distance or **remote learning** is the ideal way to study. There are several benefits that immediately come to mind. Not only the cost, which is far less than it would be to attend a college with **high tuition fees** but the ability to study at your own speed.*

*It is usually agreed that some find that this method of learning suits them better than sitting in lectures or going to tutorials which demands more self-motivation and discipline.*

Work or career

1. **A field (of work):** an area or type of career
2. **Motivated about:** wanting to do well in
3. **Internship:** working for a short time, sometimes unpaid
4. **Apprenticeship:** hands on, or practical work to learn a job
5. **Hands on:** getting involved and doing everything to help
6. **Innovative small companies:** with new, creative ideas
7. **Cutting edge:** the best new technology
8. **Diagnose:** to find out what is wrong
9. **Pediatrics:** specialist child medicine (also spelled paediatrics)
10. **Routine check ups:** a regular (not urgent) visit to the doctors
11. **Huge appreciation:** gratefulness and gratitude
12. **Follow up care:** an appointment after an operation or illness
13. **Lucrative:** money making or profitable
14. **Highly merited:** well deserved
15. **Career ladder:** moving up through promotions to the top of the company
16. **Pension scheme:** money for retirement
17. **Job security:** knowing you can keep your job / job safety
18. **Startup community:** new small businesses sometimes internet based

IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you have a job right now?**

*Not at the moment, in fact I am currently studying for my Masters in Psychology which I am finding really interesting but also very challenging. I have always been fascinated by Psychology, so I decided to learn more about this **important field**.*

**Examiner: Will you plan to use this learning in your future career?**

*Well, I hope it will be useful for me but as a future career what I am really **motivated about** is to work in Environmental studies, which is particularly relevant and topical in the current climate crisis. I will be looking for an **internship** in the USA or even an **apprenticeship** which might be more practical and **hands on**.*

**Examiner: What qualifications would you need for this job?**

*I am not exactly sure. Whilst my degree in Psychology is interesting, I'm not convinced that it will be as useful as studies in Biology or even Geography might be. However, I have managed to gain informative and **valuable work experience** in a range of **innovative small companies** who are at the **cutting edge** of this **field** so I hope that will be useful.*

- **important field.**
- **motivated about**
- **internship**
- **apprenticeship**
- **hands on**
- **valuable work experience**
- **innovative small companies**

- cutting edge

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a job that would be classified as crucial or highly important**

**You should say:**

- **what the job is**
- **what the job involves**
- **why it is important**

**and explain if people who do this job are appreciated enough by society**

*There is no doubt in my mind that workers who dedicate themselves to the Health profession should be considered highly important or key. Not just in this recent COVID pandemic, but in all situations, day or night, local or global, we depend on nurses, doctors, consultants and medical professionals to **diagnose, care for** and **cure us**.*

*It's definitely not a career for the faint hearted and if you are after job flexibility or a dependable nine to five it's not the one for you. As an example, a friend of mine who had always been determined to be a Doctor, is currently practicing in at a London hospital and specialises in children's medicine or **pediatrics**. He is involved in the A and E department, so has to react swiftly and calmly in all kinds of worrying situations but always appear optimistic though, sadly he has often had to break bad news to families.*

*Of course, a career in Medicine is one of the most important there is as we are totally dependent on being able to get help when we need it, everything from **routine checkups** to specialist consultancies, operations and **follow up care**.*

*Of course, there has always been **huge appreciation** and acknowledgment for our doctors and nurses and this continues to grow. Whilst in many countries, medics are well paid, in others, the job is not lucrative, although there is no doubt that the **gratitude** the public feel towards medics is overwhelming.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Which jobs would you say are most respected in your country?**

*Similar to many countries, the well-established fields of law, education, and medicine may be the most highly-acclaimed ones. It is usually thought that people specialising in these fields can easily earn lucrative income compared to others, although there is no doubt that many years of study are required which can be both expensive and highly challenging so the rewards are **hugely merited**.*

**Examiner: Some people say it's better to work for yourself than be employed by a company. What's your opinion?**

*Working as an employee can offer many benefits, such as a **reliable salary**, the possibility of moving up the **career ladder** for promotion, as well as being a member of a **pension scheme**. It is often acknowledged that being a full-time employee can be demanding and very stressful. However, being self-employed, while being appealing does not offer much **job security**.*

**Examiner: What changes in employment have there been in recent years in your country?**

*As far as I know, more and more people, especially the young generations are involved in setting up their own businesses as this is seen as offering more independence, more flexibility and the chance to be creative, and to earn substantial sums. So, the “**start-up**” **community** is now more alive than ever, especially **tech start-ups** which are diverse and very exciting with a lot of potential to grow exponentially.*

## University and student life

1. **Challenging:** academically difficult
2. **Day in, day out:** full time without a break
3. **Wide ranging:** covering a large spectrum / area of different knowledge
4. **Undergraduate:** studying for a degree but having not yet achieved it.
5. **Postgraduate:** having achieved a degree and now studying for a higher qualification, possibly a professions qualification
6. **STEM subjects:** Science, Technology, Engineering and Maths
7. **Further education:** studies after leaving school
8. **Technical colleges:** places which do not demand such high entrance qualifications as university
9. **Vocational studies:** focus on learning or mastering a skill
10. **Hands on training:** practical work/ learning
11. **To apply for a course:** the process of registering for a university
12. **To get an (un)conditional offer:** an offer which does not depend on previous exam results
13. **Halls of residence / student accommodation:** a particular place to live for students
14. **Student union:** an organisation for students / sometimes a physical place
15. **A fresher / an undergraduate / a graduate:** a new student, someone studying for a Bachelors degree, a student who has finished their Degree
16. **A graduation ceremony:** a formal occasion when Degrees are given out
17. **To take a gap year:** a year between study and university
18. **To drop out of university:** to leave before the course is finished
19. **Out of my depth:** finding work / study too hard
20. **Seminar:** smaller class of students with a Professor leading the discussion
21. **Lecture theatre:** large building for a talk / lecture
22. **Extensive research:** in depth work done in a particular academic field

### IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: What subject are you studying at University?**

*Sophia: I finished my Bachelor's Degree a few years ago, and that was in Biology, as I have always enjoyed the Sciences, and I am currently studying for my Masters in Psychology which I am finding really interesting but also very **challenging**.*

**Examiner: What will you do after finishing your studies?**

*Joy: I am not sure if I would like to actually become a Psychologist, working with **mental health and neurological patients day in, day out** but maybe I can use this **wide ranging** and **specialist** knowledge to find work in Heath care, where there is a short supply of well qualified professionals.*

**Examiner: Is there an increased trend for Further education in your country?**

*Andre: Yes, in the past decade there has been an explosion of those seeking extra qualifications as the jobs market is very competitive. Not only are there many more **undergraduate** places, but the demand for **postgraduate studies** has also grown, particularly in **STEM subjects** which is a positive development.*

### IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe an experience or meeting you had at University.**

**You should say:**

- **what it was**
- **when you had this experience or meeting**
- **where you had this experience**

**and explain why this experience/ meeting had an impact on you.**

*I would like to talk about my own personal experience studying at a **Further Education college** in Germany a few years ago. I had enrolled at a **technical college**, as I was looking for a practical, **vocational course** in order to learn more about engineering and I had hoped that this course would include an element of hands on training as well as formal classroom learning.*

*When I arrived at the College, I was allocated a place at a Hall of Residence which I had thought would be located close to the Lecture Theatres, however in fact, it was a 30 minute bus ride away. This was a disaster as far as making friends was concerned – it made it very hard to get involved in a **university social life**, which everyone knows is meant to be exciting and great fun.*

*At one of the seminars in our first month I explained my accommodation issue to one of my new tutors, a very kind Professor who was one of the leading experts in her field, and she was very sympathetic, and fully understood that this hall of residence was located a long way from the Student's Union and other student areas.*

*Suddenly, while we were talking, her eyes lit up, like she had had an inspired idea! She explained that she was looking for a lodger or tenant as she lived in a large, empty house and she offered me the chance to rent a room in her house which I gratefully accepted.*

*For the next three years, I lived in central Berlin with this enormously wise, kind and intelligent Professor. She challenged and motivated me to study as hard as I could, as at one point I had considered dropping out because I was rather out of my depth in some of the technical detail of the course, and when I finally graduated, she was cheering the loudest at my **Graduation Ceremony**.*

*I was very lucky to have formed such a strong bond with this amazing teacher and the impact she had on me was life changing as now I intend to specialise in the same field as her.*

**IELTS speaking part 3**

**Examiner: Is higher education too expensive in your country?**

*I think that it is very costly to go into higher education in my country. Prices rose dramatically a few years ago, making it extremely difficult for most people to afford it.*

***Tuition fees** are largely funded by loans which need to be repaid over a **working life time**, but while spending thousands on an education is worth every penny, it can, as a consequence, bring years of debt to a student and their family.*

*In today's society, no one is guaranteed to get a good job straight after university, so these **course fee debts** often continue to follow them around for life.*

**Examiner: What advantages do universities bring to society?**

*I think that there are many positive things that universities or further education colleges can offer communities and neighbourhoods around them.*

*They bring students into the area for one, which means housing will be in demand. They will spend money on food, go out to eat and socialise and invest in books (new as well as second hand) for their course, making the town or city **a buzzing hub of student life**.*

*The Students themselves benefit from having a high level of education, which can then be translated into skills in the workplace, keeping society progressing and the economy profitable with their increased skills and knowledge.*

**Examiner: Which is more important, research or teaching?**

*This is an interesting debate which has come to the fore as the tuition fees for University are so high and students are demanding high quality **contact time**.*

*I think that for those students or potential Professors who **undertake research**, there is the need to complete a Master's degree or a PhD.*

*This can develop a further understanding of a subject and allow graduates to develop their research skills. Many people who complete these higher levels of education, also teach at University or College as a way of **sharing their knowledge** and **gaining respect** from their peers. It is not really possible to teach at that level without undertaking some sort of **extensive research**.*

## Accommodation

### IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you currently live in a house or a flat?**

*At the moment I am living in a rented flat because I have recently moved into a new central **neighbourhood**. This has taken a bit of getting used to, if I'm honest, as previously I lived in a **detached house** in the suburbs which was much more comfortable.*

**Examiner: What was the family home like where you grew up?**

*I was lucky to be brought up in a large family home which was where my grandparents lived before my parents. This **ancestral home** was seeped in family history and I have always felt a great attachment to it. It is far more **spacious** than the urban loft where I am now, with larger, airier rooms and inspiring **panoramic views**. The house has a large veranda where we share family meals, a study and a cellar where my father keeps his best wine.*

**Examiner: Have you ever shared a flat with people you did not know before?**

*Well, when I used to live in London, I could not afford to rent a place of my own, so I decided to join **a flat share** which I saw advertised on an **accommodation website**. It was a real challenge as the flat was in need of modernisation, and whilst the rooms **boasted original features**, such as original Victorian windows, it was freezing cold and my flatmates kept to themselves so it was hard to make friends.*

### IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a house or an apartment that you would like to live in. You should say**

- **What kind of accommodation it would be**
- **where it would be**
- **who would live there with you**
- **and why you would enjoy living in this place**

*I have always been attracted to the idea of **constructing** my own home, as my father is an architect and we have always been great fans of watching TV programmes which follow the trials and tribulations of people who are involved in complicated and **ambitious building projects**. Sometimes, although there are many difficulties and unexpected challenges along the way, the end resulting home is just beautiful, appealing and really inspiring.*

*This small house would be by the sea, possibly in France, as the Atlantic coastline there is still quite wild and underpopulated. I'm attracted to the idea of an **environmentally friendly bungalow**, which would be **open plan** and use screens or bookshelves to divide rooms.*

*I'd love to work with my father on the design, and ideally it would be made of **eco-friendly materials**, such as **sustainable woods**, recycled glass and **highly insulated** to keep **energy costs** as low as possible. I've been inspired by the Scandinavian style houses I have seen in design magazines, which are planned to blend into their location, looking simple and clean from the outside, but **boasting all mod cons** inside.*

*I would love to have a large terrace to sit and watch the sunsets or share **sustainably sourced** local foods. I am not tempted by an **extravagant, designer or flashy décor** but prefer something **understated** with stripped or varnished wood floors, a kitchen made from recycled wood, and open shelves to display my collection of ceramic pottery which was my grandmothers. Light is very important to me, so I would try to incorporate large full length windows to enjoy the views and experience a connection to the peaceful countryside outside.*

### IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: In your country is it more common to rent or buy a house?**

*Over the past twenty years there has been a **surge in property prices**, fuelled by relaxation in the rules surrounding **mortgages and loans**. This has resulted in a **boom in the housing market**. Many young professionals are taking the opportunity to **get on the property ladder** but for most first time buyers, many years of renting is needed to save enough for a **deposit**.*

**Examiner: Many landlords are known to take advantage of their tenants. What can be done to control this?**

*It is well known that in many urban areas, which are overcrowded and where accommodation is in very short supply, that **unscrupulous landlords** charge excessive rents and demand large deposits which they are unlikely to return in full. Improved **legal protection** should be provided for tenants, many of whom are unaware of their rights, and this might give **leaseholders** more confidence and security.*

**Examiner: It is preferable for families to live in central districts or in the suburbs?**

*The trend for parents with young children has relocate from the metropolis to more suburban areas is widespread in many countries. It also depends on which **neighbourhood** you want to live in but the city centres have become **too expensive** for normal, middle income families or people to live there. Outside the centre, there are the **new hipster neighbourhoods**, where many creative or entrepreneurs and artists live, but there can be a **shortage of family sized homes**.*

Books, film and art

1. **Curl up with a book:** to get comfortable and read.
2. **Thrillers or action books:** exciting and full of events
3. **A strong plotline:** good story which keeps moving
4. **Cover to cover:** from start to finish
5. **Rom-com movie:** a romantic comedy film
6. **Adapted from fiction:** a film which was first a book
7. **Strong characterisation:** the main people are well rounded and believable
8. **Recommended to me by a friend:** someone suggested that I read it
9. **Black humour:** funny but rather dark or mysterious as well
10. **Genre:** the type of film. E.g. horror or comedy
11. **Commercial blockbusters:** films made for the mass market to generate a lot of income
12. **A sea change in something:** a fundamental shift
13. **Online streaming:** watching via the internet
14. **To commission a film:** to ask for one to be made
15. **A valid perspective:** a real view / outlook/insight to something
16. **Cultural heritage:** the background and history of a country

IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you enjoy reading for pleasure?**

*Yes, I do, but I admit that, with all my studies right now, I don't have a lot of time to **curl up with a book**. When I do, for example on holiday, I love **thrillers or action books with a strong plot line** which I can read **cover to cover** in a few hours.*

**Examiner: Would you rather watch a film or read in your free time?**

*Oh, I would far rather distract myself with a great **rom-com movie** than read as by the time I get home from work I am shattered! I know movies leave less to the imagination than books, however, I do sometimes watch films which have been **adapted from fiction**, for example, Emma by Jane Austin, which gave me an insight into **strong characterisation** and main themes.*

**Examiner: What was the last book you read and would you recommend it?**

*In fact, I have recently finished **an inspiring book** called The Human History. It was **recommended to me by a colleague**, and the themes are philosophy, kindness and communication. I found the narrative **captivating, compelling and surprisingly comprehensible**. I would definitely recommend it to anyone interested in understanding humanity a little better.*

IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a book or a film that had a strong impact on you.**

**You should say:**

- **What was it**
- **When you read or saw it**

- **How it influenced you**

**And say if you liked it and why.**

*When I used to live in Paris as a teenager, I became rather obsessed with watching what might be called 'artistic' French films. My favourite was called Paris at Midnight and was **directed by** Louis Truffaut. Often he filmed in **black and white** and told a rather dark story – the **genre** could be described as **black humour** or drama, I suppose.*

*While many of my friends were happily absorbed in the latest James Bond movie or other rather **commercial blockbusters**, I took pride in educating myself in the traditions of the French cinema and trying to learn a bit of French at the same time.*

*This film in particular had a **lasting impression** on me – I think in fact, it had been **adapted from** a best seller and since, it has inspired other cartoon spin-offs and series as well. The beautiful, mysterious heroine was both **provocative and enchanting** – it was impossible to predict how she would react in a situation, which kept the **tension** in the film very high. Added to this was a **haunting musical score**, written by a famous French musician, and this also became a top selling album in the charts.*

*This film, and others like it, **inspired me to** work harder on my French language skills and to really investigate the history and culture of Paris in greater depth. At the time, I would have said that I enjoyed it, but in hindsight, I think it was probably not a very relaxing watch, and today, I would opt for something less intellectual!*

### IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Do you think people go to the cinema as much as they used to?**

*No, and there has been a **sea change** in the way people chose to view films nowadays which has been reinforced by the recent pandemic when cinemas and theatres were closed. Even before this disaster, many film-goers had the option to pay for **online streaming** of the latest releases via the internet so they could enjoy the thrills of the cinema but without leaving their sofas. Companies like Netflix and Amazon have led the way in this new trend and now **commission films** and drama series of their own.*

**Examiner: Should art still play a role in education for students at school, as well as books and films?**

*It is true that for many young adults and school children art is not part of their usual education, and they are only able to access an understanding of great, **historic and influential paintings** if they study art. Many educators argue that art should play as big a role as the **appreciation of books or film** in the curriculum as art offers an **equally valid perspective** on a country's **cultural background and heritage**.*

**Examiner: What do you think about e-books?**

*In my opinion, **paperback** or **hardback** books are much better and reading a book from an **e-reader** just doesn't feel the same for me. Many readers value the sensation of turning pages and that special smell of paper. I think that the look and feel of a book can never be replaced by an e-reader, but I understand usefulness of electronic books. It is very convenient to be able to carry hundreds of books in your pocket especially when travelling or studying.*

Climate Change

1. **The ravages of something:** destruction of something
2. **Hybrid car:** a car that uses both petrol and electricity
3. **Carbon footprint:** how much carbon dioxide is released as a result of one's activities
4. **Recycle:** breaking down products to create new products from the materials
5. **Growing season:** the time of the year when plants grow
6. **Yields:** amount of a crop produced
7. **Crops:** a plant grown in large amounts
8. **Eco-conscious:** describes someone who shows concern for the environment
9. **Natural fertilizer:** fertilizers that come from animal waste, animal matter or plant matter
10. **Chemical fertilizer:** fertilizers that are made from synthetic materials
11. **Contaminate:** to make something impure, poisonous or polluted
12. **Groundwater:** water that is below the earth's surface
13. **Vegetable scraps:** bits of vegetables that are discarded
14. **Non-chemical compost:** decaying matter such as food, leaves or manure used to fertilize soil
15. **Organic:** describes something that does not use chemical fertilizers
16. **Commute:** travel to and from work
17. **Solar panels:** panels that collect rays from the sun to be used as energy for electricity or heating
18. **Household cleaning products:** products that are used to clean one's home
19. **Time-consuming:** describes something that takes a lot of time
20. **Environmentally conscious:** when a person or business is aware of their effect on the environment and attempts to minimize this affect
21. **Green lifestyle:** a way of living that attempts to reduce usage of water & power, waste and toxic substances
22. **Sustainable:** describes something that causes minimal damage to the environment
23. **Emulate:** to copy someone's behavior out of respect
24. **Conventional products:** products that have been in use for a long time
25. **Energy saving:** describe products designed to reduce use of electricity or other form of energy
26. **Fuel emissions:** gases that lead to air pollution through the burning of fuel
27. **Electric cars:** vehicles that run on electricity
28. **Food miles:** the distance food travels from the time it is produced until it reaches its end customer
29. **Local food:** food that is produced a short distance from where it is consumed
30. **Fossil fuels:** coal, gas or oil that is used in industry, homes and vehicles
31. **Carbon monoxide:** a dangerous gas produced from the partial burning of fuels
32. **Dispose:** throw away
33. **Waterways:** lakes, rivers, oceans and canals
34. **Ecosystem:** the geographic area where animals, plants and other organisms interact
35. **Natural habitat:** the area where a plant or animal normally lives
36. **Tackle:** to try to deal with a problem
37. **Collective effort:** when a group of people try to do something
38. **Forge:** to create something strong or successful

IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Is the environment a big concern in your country?**

*Climate change is a topic on everyone's lips in my country but only in a theoretical sense. I don't see citizens or the government taking steps to reduce **the ravages of** climate change.*

**Examiner: What steps do you and your family take to protect the environment?**

*Well, we are looking into purchasing a **hybrid car**, for one thing. My partner uses the car quite a bit for work so it is important we do not have a large **carbon footprint**. It goes without saying that we **recycle** anything we can and we also use fabric bags when we go shopping to reduce the amount of plastic waste we produce.*

**Examiner: Has the environment in your region changed since when you were younger?**

*Every summer it feels like the sun is getting hotter and hotter and the climate is nothing like it used to be. My country relies heavily on farming and I know farmers are increasingly concerned about how climate change is affecting their **growing season** and their **yields**. It is predicted that regions that were once too cold to grow certain **crops** will soon be able to.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a person you know who is doing something to protect the environment**

**You should say**

- **Who this person is**
- **What this person is doing to protect the environment**
- **How easy/difficult it is for him/her to do this**

**And explain how you feel about what this person is doing to protect the environment**

*I think everyone nowadays is doing their part to some degree to protect the environment but one person I know really does more than her fair share. This is my friend Eva, who is more **eco-conscious** than most people I think.*

*When we were in school, Eva campaigned to get a **compost bin** placed in our school yard so that the gardening club would have **natural fertilizer**. She was very concerned about **chemical fertilizers contaminating groundwater**.*

*Students, parents and teachers brought their **vegetable scraps** to be composted and it worked! We had an endless supply of **non-chemical compost** for our garden. She started using reusable cups and bottles long before they were popular and I don't think I have ever seen her carry a plastic bag.*

*Nowadays, she is part of a neighborhood clean- up group that removes rubbish from our local parks and beaches. She grows **organic** vegetables in her garden and **commutes** to work with her bicycle every day. Her house uses **solar panels** for heating and she even makes her own **household cleaning products**.*

*Eva never complains about these activities being **time-consuming** or difficult; she just feels she is doing what she can to be **environmentally conscious**. So, Eva is a person not doing just one thing to protect the environment, but in fact following a **green lifestyle** in order to live **more sustainably**. I admire her and her efforts and she is truly a role model for all of us to try to **emulate**.*

### IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: What are some things ordinary people can do to protect the environment?**

Andre: There are small and more significant actions people can take to protect the environment. Whenever there is a choice between a **conventional product** or more environmentally friendly one, we should always choose the latter. Light bulbs is one small example. The **energy saving** ones might be a little more expensive but the benefits are worth it.

We also need to think about some of our other choices that contribute to **fuel emissions**. Switching to **hybrid** or **electric cars** is one obvious answer but what about air travel in general? What about the products we consume? We need to think about the **food miles** behind what we eat and make every effort to eat **local food**.

**Examiner: What are some ways in which industries damage the environment?**

Sophie: Unfortunately, industries destroy the environment in a variety of ways. Factories use **fossil fuels** to run machines and the smoke and **carbon monoxide** released lead to air pollution. Factories **dispose** of their waste in nearby **waterways**, creating water pollution.

This in turn affects the entire **ecosystem** as sea animals and the birds and other animals that eat them suffer as a result. Even the noise from industries affect the environment. Many animals abandon their **natural habitat** once a factory is built, creating an imbalance in the ecosystem.

**Examiner: Do you believe that international cooperation is necessary to solve environmental problems?**

I think international cooperation is the only way to **tackle** environmental issues. It is meaningless if one country takes measures to protect the environment, but its neighbor does not.

There must be a **collective effort** around the world where leaders agree to the steps that must be taken. While there are many companies globally that are trying to be greener to make true progress an international agreement must be **forged**.

## Working from home

1. **Flexibility:** being able to change or be changed depending on circumstances
2. **Work-life balance:** the time spent at your job in comparison to the time spent on your personal life
3. **Distraction:** something that takes away your attention from something else
4. **Burnout:** fatigue or tiredness from being overworked
5. **Sense of community:** when members of a group have a feeling of belonging and that they matter to one another
6. **Colleagues:** people you work with
7. **Camaraderie:** the feeling of friendship and trust that people who work together or spend time together share
8. **Teamwork:** when people work together to accomplish a goal
9. **Isolation:** the feeling or state of being separated from others
10. **Productivity:** how much you work you produce in relation to how much time you spend
11. **Workplace:** any location where a person performs a job
12. **Work remotely or remote work:** when an employee works from home rather than an office and uses the phone and/or computer to communication
13. **Telecommute:** same as "remote work"
14. **Chained to a desk:** when someone feels forced or obligated to work exclusively from their desk
15. **9 to 5:** the typical hours of work in many countries. Also can mean normal sometimes boring or mundane jobs.
16. **Carbon footprint:** how much carbon dioxide someone/ somethings actions create
17. **Sustainability benefits:** the results of protecting the environment through less waste and less pollution
18. **Environmentally friendly:** describes things or activities that do not harm the environment
19. **Financially viable:** describes something that allows companies to generate income, fulfill responsibilities and continue to grow
20. **Supervision:** when someone manages a person or department to make sure rules are followed and work is done correctly
21. **Lockdown:** when people are not allowed to leave an area as a security measure
22. **Hybrid work:** work from both home and office
23. **Autonomy:** when you make decisions for yourself without the control of others

## IELTS speaking part 1

### Examiner: Do you prefer to work from home or at an office?

*I most certainly prefer working from home. It gives me **flexibility** I would never have in an office environment. Plus, my **work-life balance** has never been better; I can get in a workout in the morning, pick my daughter up from school, plus I don't have to spend time and money **commuting** to an office.*

*There may be some added **distractions** at home while I should be working but overall working from home has kept me from office **burnout**. To be honest, I found more distractions when I work from an office!*

### Examiner: Why do you think some people prefer to work in an office?

*Well, there are definitely benefits! For one, you develop **a sense of community** with your **colleagues**. There is the banter, the **camaraderie**... even the gossip! You have an atmosphere of **teamwork** in a conventional **work environment** whereas working from home can really lead to **isolation**.*

### Examiner: Do you think more people will work from home in the future?

*The global pandemic forced many people to work from home – for some it was successful and for others less so. So I think that future trends will depend on what outcomes we see from the shift to wfh during COVID-19. If institutions found it worked for them without a drop in **productivity** or an increase in costs then we may see the home as the **workplace** of the future.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

### Describe your ideal job

#### You should say

- **What the job is**
- **What skills are necessary to do the job**
- **Where the job is done**

#### And why you think this job would be interesting to do

*The job I think would be interesting to do would definitely be something involving writing. I have always loved to write but what makes it ideal is that this job allows a tremendous amount of **flexibility**.*

*A writer can work either in an office or **remotely**. One day you might be writing from Paris and the next day from New York! Your office is wherever you are and thanks to modern technology, **telecommuting** works like a breeze!*

*Furthermore, you're not **tied to a desk 9 to 5**. A writer can create a schedule that works for him or her. Personally, I am a night owl so I like working late into the night – you couldn't do that in an office job!*

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Many people believe that for companies to improve their carbon footprint they should allow more employees to work from home. Do you agree?**

*Working from home does have a number of **sustainability benefits**. When employees work from home, there is a reduction in carbon monoxide emissions from cars, so in that sense, working from home is **environmentally friendly**.*

*Also, everything must be done electronically – so there's no unnecessary waste of paper by printing work documents. Plus, businesses can move into smaller spaces that use fewer resources like heat, water and electricity, so it's also really **financially viable**.*

**Examiner: Why do you think some employees resist working from home?**

*To be honest, it can be a challenge to feel motivated when you are working without any **supervision** so it's easy to slack off and some employees might not want that.*

*Another issue is that there is no separation of your home and work life so that might lead to **burnout**.*

*In some professions, working from home is difficult because they may not have the office equipment required to do their job properly. Of course, we can't forget the social component of the **workplace** which is paramount for lots of people.*

**Examiner: How do you predict work will change in the future?**

*Well, I think **lockdowns** have taught us a number of lessons that we will take with us into the future. For example, I think we'll start seeing **hybrid work** become more common.*

*This would involve working both from home and from an office on certain days of the week, for certain functions, like meetings or events.*

*If this does happen, I think it will be a wonderful development as it really embraces the needs of the employee as an individual, different personal obligations, working styles, timetables and so on.*

*We're realizing the Monday through Friday, 9 to 5 model does not fit everyone so I think embracing hybrid work more will give people the **autonomy** to create a work schedule that works for them, resulting in higher **productivity** and happier employees – and happier companies.*

## Social media

1. **Viral:** if a post/ video is viral or “has gone viral,” that means it is spreading very rapidly across the internet,
2. **Troll:** used as a verb and a noun. A troll is a person who purposely creates offensive or provocative posts or comments to arouse anger in other social media users.
3. **Hater:** a person who posts negative or critical comments about others
4. **Vlogger:** a person who regularly creates short videos to be posted online
5. **Meme:** a humorous image or text that is easily sent to others over the internet
6. **Anonymity:** The state of being anonymous, of people not knowing your identity
7. **DM:** direct message
8. **Emoji:** a small digital image used in social media/ emails/ text to display an emotion, object or idea
9. **Badger:** to bother someone repeatedly
10. **Derogatory:** offensive, hurtful, disrespectful
11. **Censor:** to keep certain images. Texts, etc from being displayed or published because it is offensive or immoral
12. **Follow:** to subscribe to the page of a person or business on social media
13. **Harass:** to create a hostile situation through written or verbal communication
14. **Catfishing:** the act of creating a false internet profile in order to deceive or scam someone
15. **Grooming:** preparing someone (often a minor) over the internet in order to eventually commit a sexual offense
16. **Influencer:** a person who promotes a product online to his/her followers so that they may purchase it
17. **Photoshop:** software that allows users to digitally alter their images
18. **Filters:** preset photo enhancements that users can select to apply to their images or videos
19. **Block:** stopping or banning someone from interacting with you on social media or viewing your posts/ profile
20. **Scam:** a dishonest attempt to trick or cheat you

## IELTS speaking part 1

### Examiner: Is social media popular in your country?

*Very much. Many people, especially the young, are trying to become **vloggers** and **influencers**. They try to accumulate as many **followers** as possible. Apparently, there are people in my country earning a considerable income from this.*

### Examiner: Do you use social media often?

*I must confess that I am an avid user of social media. I am constantly **DMing** my friends the newest **memes** and the latest **viral** videos. It's a way to connect with them even when we can't be together.*

### Examiner: Why do some people choose not to use social media?

*the internet is still in many ways, like the wild west with very little legislation or controls. It is extremely easy to fall prey to **scammers** trying to trick you out of money or even worse, your identity. Social media sites are full of **trolls** who only post in order to incite a reaction or **haters** who **badger** other posters or spew negativity everywhere.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

## Talk about your favorite social media site or application

### Say when you first used it

- **Why you use it**
- **How often you use it**
- **And if you recommend it to others**

*While many people my age have moved on to Snapchat or TikTok, Instagram remains my favorite social media site for a variety of reasons. I started using this app five years ago when I started experimenting with photography and I find that it is an application that allows me to express myself creatively, by using various **filters** for my photography or videos to create an effect I desire.*

*I have accumulated a rather large number of followers over the years, but I certainly would not call myself an **influencer**. I now use the application at least 3 times a week to post stories or to **dm** my friends and followers.*

*I still enjoy using Instagram very much and would absolutely recommend it to others ....but you do need to have thick skin if you amass a large following. I have had people make **derogatory** comments to me which can be rather upsetting but fortunately you can **block** them easily. I have been fortunate so far, but some people I know have been victims of **catfishing**, which can be traumatic.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

### Examiner: At what age are children are generally allowed to use social media in your country?

*I think it really depends on which application the child is using. Some applications generally expose a child more to potential predators or **cyberbullies** so I think children should be at least 15 to use them. I have heard that predators create fake profiles in order to groom children – this is despicable and is just one reason why parents should monitor their children's device use.*

### Examiner: Do you think people will social media more or less in the future?

*With so many things changing so quickly, it's rather difficult to predict what the future holds. A few years ago we were sending **emojis** to one another and now everywhere you look people are dancing in front of their cameras for the world to see. So, I imagine our obsession with social media will continue although I hesitate to predict what form that will take.*

### Examiner: Why do you think bullying on the internet has become so widespread?

*I think **cyberbullies** and **trolls** generally feel that a shield of **anonymity** protects them. Many people are on social media area out there with dummy profiles harassing people at will and I guess like in all kinds of bullying, it makes the bully feel important or worthy. So the bully gets the validation he or she needs without any of the repercussions that might occur if the bullying were to take place in the real world.*

## Advertising

1. **Commercials:** an advert on TV or radio
2. **Imagery:** visual images
3. **Tantalizing:** something that creates desire and excitement
4. **Live up to its hype:** when something is as good as you expected it to be
5. **Product placement:** a practice in movies or tv shows when a product or its brand name appear on screen visibly in order to gain exposure
6. **Celebrity endorsement:** when a famous person advertises a product by saying he or she uses it
7. **Grating:** describes sounds that are annoying
8. **Inclined to purchase:** likely to buy
9. **Potential customers:** people who might possibly buy your product
10. **Turn someone off:** to make someone uninterested in something
11. **Pop-ups:** advertisements that suddenly appear on a computer or device screen.
12. **Subconscious:** the part of the brain that sees, hears or remembers things that you do not actively remember
13. **Subliminal:** describes something that can influence the subconscious mind without the conscious mind realizing it
14. **Billboards:** a large outdoor board, usually alongside large roads, used to display an ad
15. **Flyer:** a small paper advertising a product, business or event
16. **Website traffic:** the internet users who visit a website
17. **Brand awareness:** when customers recognize or remember a brand and its qualities
18. **Jingle:** music that accompanies commercials
19. **Telemarketing:** the marketing of good or services over the phone
20. **Bombard:** attack continuously
21. **Buying power:** the money someone has to buy things
22. **Free-for-all:** a situation with no rules, limits or restrictions
23. **Impressionable:** describes a person who is easily influenced

## IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you remember any adverts you saw when you were younger?**

*Oh certainly! I remember a dollhouse that was featured for quite some time on television but I also remember **commercials** for adult products like bath soap or beer. I can't really say what was so memorable about these commercials – perhaps the **imagery** or the **jingle**, but years later I most definitely remember them.*

**Examiner: Do you often buy things after seeing an advert?**

*Sometimes I do, yes. If I believe that a product satisfies a particular need I have, then I may purchase it. Sometimes, in the case of food, the products displayed are so **tantalizing** that you may try the product just to see if it **lives up to its hype**.*

**Examiner: Do you like it when celebrities advertise products?**

*No, actually I don't. I think **celebrity endorsements** cheapen the celebrity and insult the public's intelligence. It's fairly obvious that the celebrity is advertising the product only to earn a large amount of money and quite frankly, even if he or she does use the product, that does not automatically mean the product is right for me or will make me more similar to the celebrity.*

What is even worse than celebrity endorsements is when you see **product placements** in movies. There have been times when a soft drink was so prominently displayed on the screen that it was laughable. These types of ads repel me rather than attract me.

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe an advert you saw recently. You should say:**

- **What the product/ service was**
- **Where you saw it**
- **How was the product/ advertised**
- **And how you felt about it**

To be honest, I don't watch a lot of television although it is on in my house rather often. Lately, I have repeatedly heard adverts for a brand of cheese available in my country. I say I "heard" them because it was the music that has stuck out in my mind. The commercial uses a folk song throughout the commercial that I find rather **grating**.

It's the kind of jingle – and commercial that makes me want to change the channel immediately!!! However, I think that this kind of advertising is very effective; if you like the song then you may be **more inclined to purchase** the product. If though you are like me and don't like the song, then the ad is still successful because it has gotten my attention!

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Examiner: Do you think advertising will change in the future?**

I think advertising is probably one of the fastest changing industries today. It must always adapt and find new ways of getting the attention of **potential customers** without **turning them off**. I think several years ago we could have in no way imagined how important Youtube or Facebook would be for advertisers so I believe in the future we will see more changes as more apps and sites become popular.

**Examiner: How is advertising different now in relation to the past?**

Advertising in the past relied more heavily on print, like magazines, newspapers and **billboards**. I can't recall the last time I noticed a billboard while driving. Radio too is less important and maybe a great medium for local products and services. I believe TV ads remain very popular but advertising on the internet has really taken over. We are **bombarded** with so many adverts online that I don't think we even notice them anymore.

**Examiner: Some people think it is unethical to advertise to children. Do you agree?**

Apparently, in some countries children are a very powerful market with considerable **buying power**! So, it only makes sense that advertisers would want to advertise to them. However, this must be done extremely carefully. In my country there are laws forbidding advertisers from advertising toys when cartoons are playing.

In my husband's country though it is **a free-for-all** where commercials during Saturday morning cartoons promote toys, unhealthy snacks, theme parks – anything and everything that a child could – and undoubtedly does- ask for! Children are very impressionable so yes, it does seem unethical although with such financial strength I can understand why advertisers are tempted.

## Fashion and shopping

1. **Clothes horse:** someone who really likes to buy nice clothes
2. **Well put together:** describes someone who looks good and who has made effort to do so
3. **Pick up:** buy
4. **Bargain price:** a discounted price
5. **Be up on the latest trends:** to be informed of what is fashionable
6. **Social media feed:** the updated list of new content available on various social media platforms
7. **In fashion:** fashionable
8. **Replicate:** to copy
9. **Looks:** appearance
10. **Lower priced:** inexpensive, cheap
11. **A fraction of the cost:** a small part of the total cost
12. **A (great) eye for something:** able to notice or make correct judgments about something
13. **Clothes rack:** rail where clothes are hung for display
14. **Shoe display:** place where shoes are shown
15. **Level of attention:** the amount of attention someone pays to something
16. **Luxury goods:** things that are very expensive to buy but are not considered necessities
17. **High-end designers:** people who design products sold at very high prices
18. **Out of my price range:** describes something that is too expensive for someone to buy
19. **Incomparable:** cannot be compared because it is so good
20. **Over the top:** extreme, excessive, exaggerated
21. **Avant-garde:** describes music, art, etc, that are unconventional or experimental
22. **Ambience:** the atmosphere of a location
23. **Unparalleled:** exceptional; in a category of its own because of its excellence
24. **Customer service:** the assistance given to customers of a product or service
25. **Top-notch:** high quality
26. **Blow money on something:** spend large amounts of money
27. **"it" item:** something very fashionable
28. **Place pressure on:** to try to influence or persuade
29. **Stay current:** to be up to date
30. **Spoiled for choice:** to have a lot of options available to you
31. **High street:** the main street where shops, banks and businesses are located.
32. **Unfathomable:** unimaginable
33. **e-shops:** stores that do business online
34. **click of a button:** on a computer or device, something that requires very little effort
35. **at your doorstep:** at your home or near where you live
36. **superimposed:** when something is placed over something else so that the image of both items is clear
37. **frame:** the size and shape of someone's body
38. **digital imagery:** the collection of pixels on a screen that create an image
39. **brick and mortar stores:** a physical shop as opposed to an online shop
40. **counterparts:** someone who does the same job as someone else somewhere else

## IELTS speaking part 1

**Examiner: Do you enjoy shopping?**

*I do enjoy shopping – perhaps more than I should! My friends say that I am something of a **clothes horse**! I like to be **well put together** but I typically wait for the sales though so that I can **pick up** what I want at **a bargain price**.*

**Examiner: What things do you like shopping for?**

*Like many women my age, I enjoy shopping for clothes and accessories. I try **to be up on the latest trends**, so first I scan my **social media feed** for **what's in fashion** and I try to **replicate the looks** with the **lower priced** items I buy – at **a fraction of the cost** of what influencers pay!*

**Examiner: Do you prefer to shop alone or with other people?**

*If I have to buy something for an important function, then I typically bring my mother with me because she **has a great eye for** clothes. She knows what cut and style suits me. However, if I just want to pass the time, then I prefer going alone, especially in the morning when the shops are less crowded. I like inspecting the **clothes racks** or **shoe displays**.*

## IELTS speaking part 2

**Describe a shop you like going to say:**

- **where the shop is**
- **what things it sells**
- **how often you go there**
- **and why you like shopping there**

*The shop I like going to is one that I don't visit very often as it is extremely expensive but whenever I have gone, I have enjoyed the experience very much. The shop is in the center of the city in a beautiful neoclassical building with a spiral staircase.*

*There are large velvet sofas where you can rest while you are served. When you walk through the double doors, a shop assistant greets you and offers coffee and tea. They are very friendly and really try to get to know the customer.*

*Usually, I would find this **level of attention** from a shop person irritating, but here they do it in such a way that you feel they are really trying to accommodate you. The shop sells **luxury goods** from **high-end designers**. Many people feel their items are **overpriced** but I guess there is a market for these goods.*

*As I said, I don't go there often – it is **out of my price range** – but I did go when my brother was getting married to look for shoes. The selection and quality of their goods are **incomparable** – from **over-the-top avant-garde** designer items to classics that can become family heirlooms.*

*So it is the combination of factors – the store **ambience**, the **unparalleled customer service** and of course, the **top-notch** products – that make this a store I enjoy shopping at. I hope that one day I will be able to afford to shop there on a regular basis.*

## IELTS speaking part 3

**Some people think women shop more than men. Do you think this is true?**

Generally there seems to be some truth to this. I know some men who like to keep up with the latest fashions and are capable of **blowing enormous sums of money** on “it” sneakers and jeans, but on the whole, shopping seems to be a pastime more favored by women.

Firstly, I think society **places more pressure on** women to have an attractive and modern appearance, so **to stay current**, they have to update their look regularly. The fashion industry knows this, of course, and as a result the selection women have to choose from is infinite. It's not like men's clothes where your choice of trouser colors is black, grey or blue!

### How is shopping different now compared to how it was in the past?

Well, first of all, today we are **spoilt for choice**. Thanks to globalization, you no longer have to go to France to buy French goods, for example. In my city, on the **high street** we have brands from Spain, Italy, France, China and Japan.

This was **unfathomable** a few decades ago. A new element in shopping is also **e-shops**. These have made the items of your choices accessible with **the click of a button**, regardless of the location. The items arrive **at your doorstep**, sometimes even on the same day.

### How do you think shopping will change in the future?

It's difficult to say. I think technology will take the online shopping experience to a whole new level. For example, shopping will soon become even more personalized. Some sites today can recommend the best size for you based on information you provide.

I am certain that in the future this will be done merely by sending an image of yourself and the item will be **superimposed** on your **frame**! I imagine shipping will be even more efficient so that you won't have to wait a week for your item to arrive.

I also suspect **digital imagery** online will improve so that you can truly understand the details of the item you are purchasing. As far as in person shopping is concerned, **brick and mortar stores** will have a tough time competing with their online **counterparts** so the experience will have to become more efficient and more enjoyable.

Idioms for IELTS speaking exam

1. Fresh as a daisy

Someone who is lively and attractive, in a clean, fresh way.

*My sister has been travelling for almost 24 hours, and she's still as fresh as a daisy.*

2. Couch potato

Spending too much time on the internet or watching TV.

*My uncle is such a couch potato! He often spends his Saturdays watching American football on TV.*

3. Full of beans

A person who is lively, active and healthy.

*My 6 year old nephew is full of beans! He has more energy than three adults.*

4. A bad egg

Someone who is untrustworthy.

*Hey, Sue, I think your neighbor is a bad egg. He has these scary looking guys in black leather hanging around his place all the time.*

5. Down to earth

Someone who is practical and realistic.

*My aunt Karen is so down to earth. She can figure out any difficult situation, and offer a good solution.*

6. Party pooper

A person who is gloomy, and having no fun at a social gathering.

*Listen, my friend, I'm so sorry to be a party pooper, but I have to study for my IELTS speaking exam tomorrow.*

7. Eager beaver

A person who is hardworking and enthusiastic.

*My colleague drives me crazy! She is such an eager beaver that she always volunteers for overtime.*

8. Ball in your court

It's your decision or responsibility to do something now.

Well, my friend, the ball's in your court. I'll wait for your decision.

9. Throw in the towel

Give up.

*I've spent too much time on this project to throw in the towel now.*

10. Get a head start

Start before all others.

*Let's get up early tomorrow to get a head start on our drive to Toronto.*

11. Get a second wind

Have a burst of energy after tiring.

*After having a coffee and a sandwich, he got his second wind, and finished painting the kitchen.*

12. Jump the gun

Start too early.

*I think I jumped the gun by buying my friends James and Susan a wedding gift. They just called off their engagement.*

13. Give it my best shot

Try your hardest.

*This test question is really tough! I'll give it my best shot, and I'll get some marks for doing my best.*

14. On the ball

Ready and able.

*Our department receptionist is really on the ball when it comes to fielding calls from annoyed students.*